

# MORPHOSYNTAX OF A'INGAE CLAUSES AND VERB PHRASES: A DESCRIPTION

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**ABSTRACT** This paper describes the morphology and morphosyntax of verbs and clauses in A'ingae (or Cofán, iso 639-3: con, an Amazonian isolate). A'ingae is characterized by rich, predominantly head-marking morphology, robust pro-drop, relatively free (often verb-final) word order, and nominative-accusative morphosyntactic alignment. Themes emphasized in the description include the functions of A'ingae suffixes and clitics, their morphosyntactic restrictions, and the types of clauses they can appear in.

## 1 INTRODUCTION

In this paper, I describe the morphology and morphosyntax of A'ingae verbs and clauses. A'ingae (or Cofán, iso 639-3: con) is an Amazonian language isolate spoken in Ecuador and Colombia. The language is characterized by rich morphology and complex interactions between the structure of a clause and functional morphology. Correspondingly, the topics emphasized in this description include the uses of A'ingae suffixes and clitics, their morphotactic restrictions, and their relationship to different types of clauses.

A'ingae has relatively free, often verb-final, word order and nominative-accusative alignment. A simple sentence showing the prototypical A'ingae word order (subject, second-position clitic, object, verb) is given in (1).<sup>1</sup>

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<sup>1</sup> The following glossing abbreviations have been used: 1 = first person, 2 = second person, 3 = third person, ACC = accusative, ACC2 = accusative 2, ADD = additive focus, ADJ = adjectivizer, ADN = adnominal, ADV = adverbializer, AIMP = attenuated imperative, ANA = anaphora, AND = andative, ANIM = animate, APPR = apprehensional, ASSR = assertive, ATTR = attributive, AUX = auxiliary, BEN = benefactive, BND = bounded, CAUS = causative, CNTR = contrastive topic, DAT = dative, DCS = deceased, DEM = demonstrative, DIST = distal, DRN = diurnal, DS = different subject, ELAT = elative, EN = event nominalizer, EXCL = exclusive focus, FRST = frustrative, FUT = future, HORT = hortative, IDDG = indefinite of degree, IDSB = indefinite of substance, IDSL = indefinite of selection, IF = conditional, IMP = imperative, INF = infinitive, INGR = ingressive, INS = instrumental, IPFV = imperfective, IRR = irrealis, ITER = iterative, LAT = lateral, LOC = locative, MANN = manner, MM = manner of motion, NEG = negative, NEW = new topic, PASS = passive, PERM = permissive, PL = plural, PLC = place, PLS = plural subject, PRIV = privative, PROH = prohibitive, PRSP = prospective, PURP = purposive, RCPR = reciprocal, REFL = reflexive, RPRT = reportative, SG = singular, SML = similitive, SN = subject nominalizer, SS = same subject, STA = spatial/temporal anaphora, T = tense, TENT = tentative, THUS = manner demonstrative, VDM = verbal diminutive, VEN = venitive, WH = content interrogative, YNQ = polar interrogative.

## (1) PROTOTYPICAL WORD ORDER

*máma =tsû saráru=ma áthe*

mom =3 otter=ACC see

“Mom saw an otter.”

([AII](#), p. 10;<sup>2</sup> 2024-03-04(1)\_sia)

The second-position (P2) clitics, such as *=tsû* 3, encode subject-person agreement and sentence-level information. Whether and where exactly a second-position clitic may (or must) appear depends on the syntax and illocutionary force of the clause. The dependencies between P2 clitics and clause types are described throughout the paper. A background on the language is given in [Section 2](#). The basic structure of A’ingae sentences is discussed in [Section 3](#).

The A’ingae language is highly agglutinating and exclusively suffixing/encliticizing.<sup>3</sup> The majority of the language’s functional morphemes have the form *-(?)CV*. A’ingae verbs can be marked for a variety of grammatical categories ([2](#)).

## (2) VERBAL AGGLUTINATION

*kufi -án -ʔjen -ngi -ʔfa -ya -mbi -ʔni -nda*

play -CAUS -IPFV -VEN -PLS -IRR -NEG -IF.DS -NEW

“now<sub>NEW</sub> if<sub>IF</sub> (they<sub>PLS</sub>) will<sub>IRR</sub> not<sub>NEG</sub> come<sub>VEN</sub> to be<sub>IPFV</sub> making<sub>CAUS</sub> play, (someone else<sub>DS</sub>) ...”

(Dąbkowski, [2026b](#); 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

The language’s verbal inflection includes voice (e. g. the causative *-an* CAUS), aspect (e. g. the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV), associated motion (e. g. the venitive *-ʔngi* VEN), a number of situation-level categories, such as number (the plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS), reality (the irrealis *-ya* IRR), polarity (the negative *-mbi* NEG), as well as clause-level categories, such as its matrix, cosubordinate, or subordinate status (e. g. the different-subject conditional antecedent *-ʔni* IF.DS) or illocutionary force, and information structure (e. g. the new topic *-ta* NEW). The

<sup>2</sup> The following bibliographical abbreviations have been used: [AI](#) = Borman and Chica Umenda (1977), [AII](#) = Borman and Chica Umenda (1982a), [AIII](#) = Borman and Chica Umenda (1980), [AIV](#) = Borman and Chica Umenda (1982b), [AV](#) = Borman and Chica Umenda (1982c), [A4](#) = Quintero de Criollo (1969), [AC2](#) = Quenamá (1992), [B&C](#) = Borman and Criollo (1990), [BC&C](#) = Borman, Cooper, and Criollo (1991), [B&CU](#) = Blaser and Chica Umenda (2008), [C4](#) = Chica Umenda (1980), [P&C](#) = Pederson and Cooper (1982).

<sup>3</sup> In representing functional morphemes as suffixes (with a dash -) or as clitics (with an equals sign =), I adopt the following criterion: A *suffix* attaches to the head of a phrase, regardless of word order internal to that phrase. This is to say, (in so far as word order is flexible,) the head may be followed by an argument or adjunct, but a suffix will always appear on the head. An *enclitic*, on the other hand, appears next to a full phrase, regardless of the head status of its immediately adjacent word.

The above criterion has several corollaries. First, all derivational morphemes are suffixes. Second, the inflectional morphemes which appear on verbs are suffixes—they always attach to the head of the verbal predicate (i. e. the verb) and may be followed by adjuncts and arguments. Third, nominal inflectional morphemes are clitics. The word order within an A’ingae noun phrase is somewhat free. Nonetheless, nominal clitics appear outside of the entire phrase. Note that since many of the A’ingae functional morphemes may attach to bases of different lexical classes, the same morpheme may function either as a suffix (e. g. on a verb) or a clitic (e. g. on a noun phrase). For a further discussion of suffixhood/cliticity, see Dąbkowski ([2025d](#)).

morphological structure of A'ingae verbs, including the meanings of individual morphemes and their morphotactic restrictions is discussed in [Section 4](#).

Some aspects of the A'ingae clause structure and verbal morphology reflect broader patterns observed cross-linguistically or within the Amazonian sprachbund. These typological connections are noted throughout, and further summarized and discussed in [Section 5](#).

## 2 BACKGROUND

A'ingae (or Cofán, iso 639-3: con) is an underdocumented and endangered isolate spoken by ca. 1,500 Cofán people in northeast Ecuador and southern Colombia (Dąbkowski, [2021a](#)). The Cofán people originated in the Andean Cordilleras and migrated to the Amazon Basin around the 16th century (Lucitante, [2019](#)). Correspondingly, their language evinces both Andean retentions and Amazonian innovations (AnderBois, Emlen, et al., [2019](#)).

Since the colonial establishment of an anti-Indigenous political order and—most recently—the encroachment of illegal oil mining, the traditional ways of life of the Cofán people have been threatened (Cepek, [2018](#)). The resulting social destabilization and community fracturing have put language transmission in danger. Nevertheless, A'ingae is still robustly used across all domains of life, and the Cofán people's attitudes towards their language are uniformly positive (Dąbkowski, [2021a](#)).

Previous documentary work on A'ingae includes Borman's ([1976](#)) dictionary, Borman and Criollo's (B&C) collection of cosmological narratives, the Bormans' translation of *The Bible* ([1980](#)), Blaser and Chica Umenda's (B&CU) compilation of traditional A'ingae stories with Spanish translations, as well as AnderBois and Silva's ([2018](#)) and Dąbkowski's ([2020](#)) online corpora of annotated audiovisual narratives. Previous descriptive work on A'ingae includes Fischer and Hengeveld's ([2023](#)) grammatical sketch and Hengeveld and Fischer's ([in prep.](#)) descriptive grammar.

A'ingae has a relatively large phoneme inventory, with 27 consonants, five oral vowels, five nasal vowels, and 11 diphthongs (+ their nasal counterparts). The language's syllable structure is (C)V(V)(?)—i. e. onsets are optional, nuclei are maximally diphthongal, and the glottal stop is the only possible coda (Dąbkowski, [2024a](#); Repetti-Ludlow et al., [2019](#)). The glottal stops and metrical stress enter into a system of complex, morphologically mediated interactions. While a discussion of these phenomena is beyond the scope of this paper, they are transcribed throughout—stress is marked with the acute accent (´) and the glottal stop is represented as in the IPA (?). (For all other segments, the paper adopts the language's practical orthography.) For description and analyses of A'ingae stress and glottalization, see Dąbkowski ([2021c](#), [2024b](#), [2025c,d](#), [2026b](#)).

In addition, A'ingae also shows complex, partially morpheme-dependent progressive nasalization. In general, A'ingae nasality spreads across some obstruents and associates to other segments, turning oral vowels into nasal vowels, sonorants into nasal stops, and some plain stops into prenasalized ones. For more on A'ingae nasality, see Bennett et al. ([t.a.](#)),

Dąbkowski (2026a), and Sanker and AnderBois (2024). Other phonological phenomena described and analyzed in the previous literature include reduplication (Dąbkowski, 2023a), the diachrony and synchrony of diphthongs (Dąbkowski, 2023c, 2025a), and laryngeal co-occurrence restrictions (Repetti-Ludlow, 2021).

Morphological and syntactic phenomena that have received analytical treatments in the previous literature include second-position clitics (Dąbkowski, 2023b), A'ingae noun phrases (Fischer, 2002), the language's tense, aspect, mood, and evidentiality (TAME) system (Hengeveld and Fischer, 2018), clausal linkage and subordination strategies (Fischer, 2007; Fischer and van Lier, 2011), switch reference morphology (AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva, 2023), serial verb constructions (Kalpande, 2024), WH-movement and pied-piping (Dąbkowski, 2022), and the boundary-marking glottalization -ʔT (Dąbkowski, 2025b). Semantic analyses have been provided for the A'ingae anaphoric determiner *tša* ANA (Zheng and AnderBois, 2023), the connective *tsáʔma* 'but' (Morvillo and AnderBois, 2022), and the apprehensional marker *-saʔne* APPR (AnderBois and Dąbkowski, 2020, 2025; Dąbkowski and AnderBois, 2024, 2026).

The data presented in the paper come from previous publications as well as the author's original fieldwork conducted with native speakers from the communities of Dureno, Sinangoé, and Dovuno in the province of Sucumbíos, Ecuador. Previously published data are cited as such. Data collected by the author have been deposited in the California Language Archive (CLA) as Dąbkowski (2020). Most of the data points are cited with YYYY-MM-DD\_ccc identifiers pointing to specific items in the collection.<sup>4</sup>

### 3 CLAUSAL MORPHOSYNTAX

This section introduces the basics of A'ingae clausal morphosyntax. A'ingae has nominative-accusative alignment and allows for relatively unconstrained pro-drop (§3.1). The language is tenseless; the default temporal interpretation of a verb depends on its lexical aspect (§3.2). Verbal constituents of various sizes can be identified by applying diagnostics such as second-position clitic licensing. Their discussion is organized in order of increasing syntactic integration: first, matrix clauses and main sentence types (§3.3), then cosubordinate clauses (§3.4), subordinate clauses (§3.5), and serial verb constructions (§3.6). Finally, I describe aspects of the A'ingae obligatory WH-movement (§3.7).

#### 3.1 *Argument (non-)expression*

A'ingae shows nominative-accusative morphosyntactic alignment; subjects are unmarked (3) and direct objects are marked with one of two accusative clitics: *=ma* ACC (3a) or *=ve* ACC2 (3b).<sup>5</sup> In ditransitive constructions, recipients are introduced with the dative *=nga* DAT (3a).

<sup>4</sup> In a majority of the previous publications, glottalization is not reliably transcribed, and stress is very often not represented at all. To report stress and glottalization in this paper, I have reelicited all the previous data points with native speakers of A'ingae. At times, my consultants have improved on the word choice

## (3) SUBJECTS UNMARKED; OBJECTS MARKED

## a. MA-, NGA-MARKED OBJECTS

yáya dũʔshû=nga ávû=ma áfe  
dad child=DAT fish=ACC give

“Dad gave the child a fish.”

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## b. VE-MARKED OBJECT

ñá rúnda-ʔje séje-ʔsû=ve  
1SG wait-IPFV cure-SN=ACC2

“I am waiting for a doctor.”

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

A'ingae supports robust pro-drop. As such, a stand-alone clause may have an unexpressed subject (4a), object (4b), or both (4c), if the arguments are inferrable from context. The non-expression of arguments is very frequent; in many A'ingae clauses, at least one core argument is dropped.

## (4) CLAUSAL ARGUMENTS UNEXPRESSED

## a. UNEXPRESSED SUBJECT

búʔmbu síʔtsi=ma séthaen  
bombona firewood=ACC chant

“(The shaman) chanted over  
bombona firewood.”

(B&C, p. 270; 2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## b. UNEXPRESSED OBJECT

ké í-ʔnga-ja  
2SG bring-AND-IMP

“You go get (it, i. e. the  
flint).” (B&C, p. 60;

2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## c. BOTH UNEXPRESSED

jún áthe  
yes see

“Yes, (I) saw (it).”

(B&C, p. 267;  
2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## 3.2 Temporal defaults

As will be seen throughout the paper, A'ingae verbs may be marked with a wide range of inflectional affixes. However, none of them are mandatory in matrix clauses. As such, well-formed finite verbs may be identical to bare roots.

Notably, there are no morphological means in A'ingae dedicated specifically to the overt expression of tense. The default temporal interpretation of a verb depends on its lexical aspect. In the absence of inflectional morphology, *events*, i. e. verbs whose meaning involves a change, are assigned perfective aspect. Situations expressed with unmarked eventive verbs are understood as having occurred in the past (5).

## (5) EVENTS — DEFAULT PAST INTERPRETATION

a. tíse =tsû tshái  
3SG =3 hit

“S/he hit.”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

b. tíse =tsû gíyaen  
3SG =3 clean

“S/he cleaned.”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

c. tíse =tsû dyái  
3SG =3 sit

“S/he sat down.”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

or corrected some of the grammatical forms. Consequently, many data points are accompanied by more than one citation. In all such cases, the reported data reflect the choices and judgments of my consultants, not those of the original medium.

5 The choice of =ma ACC or =ve ACC2 depends on a variety of factors, including the verb's meaning, its arbitrary selectional restrictions, and properties of the object. A full discussion of the two accusative markers is beyond the scope of this paper. For one proposal discussing the semantic differences between =ma ACC and =ve ACC2, see Karsten (2021).

Matrix clauses with *states*, i. e. verbs whose meaning does not involve a change, are interpreted as true at the time of speaking. Concomitantly, they are translated using the present tense (6). Positional verbs such as *dyai* ‘sit’ allow for both eventive (5c) and stative (6c) interpretations.

(6) STATES — DEFAULT PRESENT INTERPRETATION

- |                                                                                  |                                                                                              |                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>tíse =tsû kánse</i><br>3SG =3 live<br>“S/he lives.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) | b. <i>tíse =tsû chí?ga</i><br>3SG =3 not want<br>“S/he doesn’t want.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) | c. <i>tíse =tsû dyái</i><br>3SG =3 sit<br>“S/he is sitting.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

A variety of morphosyntactic and modificational strategies can be used to change the temporal interpretations of both eventive and stative verbs. For example, eventive verbs receive non-past interpretations when inflected with the imperfective *-?je* IPFV (7a) (and some of the other aspectual suffixes; §4.2.1), in auxiliary habitual constructions, such as *-ye atesû* ‘INF know’ (7b; §3.5.2) or *-pa kanse* ‘ss live’ (§3.4), and in some subordinate structures, such as conditional antecedents (7c).

(7) NON-PAST INTERPRETATIONS OF EVENTIVE VERBS

- |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. IMPERFECTIVE ASPECT<br><i>tíse =tsû tshái-?je</i><br>3SG =3 hit-IPFV<br>“S/he is hitting.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) | b. HABITUAL AUXILIARY<br><i>tíse =tsû tshái-ye atesû</i><br>3SG =3 hit-INF know<br>“S/he often hits.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) | c. CONDITIONAL ANTECEDENT<br><i>tsá?khû kú-?ta guá?thi-ya</i><br>water warm up-T-NEW boil-IRR<br>“If warmed up, water boils.”<br>(2021-09-15_1_rgq) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

To convey the idea that the situation described by a stative verb no longer obtains (i. e. the state took place in the past), one may nominalize the verb with *-?chu* EN (8a) or simply restrict its temporal interpretation with an adverb (8b).

(8) PAST INTERPRETATIONS OF STATIVE VERBS

- |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>?CHU</i> -NOMINALIZATION<br><i>tíse =tsû kánse-?chu</i><br>3SG =3 live-EN<br>“S/he lived.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) | b. TEMPORAL ADVERB<br><i>káni =tsû kán?jen</i><br>yesterday =3 be.ANIM<br>“S/he was (somewhere) yesterday.”<br>(2024-04-12(1)_sia) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Future reference is typically expressed with the irrealis suffix *-ya* IRR or with the prospective auxiliary construction *-ye tsun?jen* ‘INF do-IPFV.’ For more on *-ya* IRR and *-ye tsun?jen* ‘INF do-IPFV,’ see Paragraph 4.3 and Section 3.5.2.

### 3.3 Matrix clauses

In A’ingae matrix clauses, the verb, its arguments, and its adjuncts can be ordered freely. The most common word orders are subject–object–verb (SOV) (9a) and subject–verb–object

(SVO) (9b). In elicitation settings, all six permutations of subject, object, and verb are accepted, but when a subject and an object are both present, verb-initial orders are identified as less natural than others (Dąbkowski, 2023b).

(9) COMMON MATRIX CLAUSAL WORD ORDERS

a. SUBJECT–OBJECT–VERB

*kurága thési=ma áthe*

shaman jaguar=ACC see

“A shaman saw a jaguar.”

(2020-11-16\_sia)

b. SUBJECT–VERB–OBJECT

*kurága áthe thési=ma*

shaman see jaguar=ACC

“A shaman saw a jaguar.”

(2020-11-16\_sia)

### 3.3.1 *Speech acts and second-position clitics*

The illocutionary force of an A'ingae sentence is often marked by explicit morphological means. In addition, the language has a set of five sentence-level clitics, which encode subject person features (first-person subject =*ngi* 1, second-person subject =*ki* 2, third-person subject =*tsû* 3), reportative evidentiality (=te RPRT), and polar interrogative status (=ti YNQ). Those clitics typically appear right after the first full constituent, i. e. in the second position. As such, I will refer to them as *second-position clitics*.

While only the polar interrogative =*ti* YNQ clitic's meaning directly relates to the type of sentence it appears in (i. e. a polar question), the distribution of all five clitics is closely linked to the presence of mood/speech act morphology. As such, the rest of this section discusses sentence functions and their compatibility with sentence-level clitics in tandem.

**DECLARATIVE SENTENCES** The matrix clauses of A'ingae declarative sentences can be morphologically unmarked (10a), in which case a finite verb is identical to the verbal root, or carry the assertive suffix =*ɣa* ASSR (10b). For more on the assertive =*ɣa* ASSR, see Paragraph 4.4.1.

(10) MORPHOLOGICAL MARKING OF DECLARATIVES

a. UNMARKED

*kurága thési=ma áthe*

shaman jaguar=ACC see

“A shaman saw a jaguar.”

(2020-11-16\_sia)

b. ɣA-MARKED

*kurága thési=ma áthe-ɣa*

shaman jaguar=ACC see-ASSR

“A shaman saw a jaguar.”

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

*The subject clitics* The second-position clitics =*ngi* 1, =*ki* 2, and =*tsû* 3 express the person feature of the matrix clause's subject. They are optional in indicative matrix clauses (11). The clitics may cooccur with noun and pronoun<sup>6</sup> subjects, thus expressing the subject person redundantly (11a-b). Yet, since A'ingae arguments are commonly dropped, a second-position clitic is often the only morphosyntactically explicit cue as to the features of the matrix

subject (11c). Nonetheless, a second-position clitic is not mandatory even when the subject is dropped. In those cases, the identity of the subject is fully context-dependent (11d).

(11) SECOND-POSITION CLITICS OPTIONAL IN MATRIX CLAUSES

- |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. SUBJECT NOUN; P2 CLITIC OPTIONAL</p> <p><i>kurága (=tsû) thési=ma áthe</i><br/> shaman =3 jaguar=ACC see<br/> “A shaman saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p> | <p>b. SUBJECT PRONOUN; P2 CLITIC OPTIONAL</p> <p><i>tíse (=tsû) thési=ma áthe</i><br/> 3SG =3 jaguar=ACC see<br/> “S/he saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p> |
| <p>c. SUBJECT DROPPED; P2 CLITIC PRESENT</p> <p><i>thési=ma =tsû áthe</i><br/> jaguar=ACC =3 see<br/> “S/he saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p>                   | <p>d. SUBJECT DROPPED; P2 CLITIC ABSENT</p> <p><i>thési=ma áthe</i><br/> jaguar=ACC see<br/> “(I, you, he, she, ... ) saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p>   |

Featural identity between the first constituent and the second-position clitic is not required (12). For example, the first-person clitic can attach to a third-person object (12a) or the third-person clitic can attach to a second-person object (12b). Likewise, any second-position clitic can attach to a verb; the clitics are compatible with the assertive suffix *-ʔya* ASSR (12c).

(12) HOST AND P2 CLITIC FEATURALLY MISMATCHED

- |                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. 3SG-OBJECT + 1-CLITIC</p> <p><i>thési=ma =ngi (ñá) áthe</i><br/> jaguar=ACC =1 1SG see<br/> “I saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p> | <p>b. 2SG-OBJECT + 3-CLITIC</p> <p><i>ké=ma =tsû (thési) áthe</i><br/> 2SG=ACC =3 jaguar see<br/> “(A jaguar) saw you.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p> | <p>c. ASSERTIVE VERB + CLITIC</p> <p><i>áthe(-ʔya) =ki thési=ma</i><br/> see-ASSR =2 jaguar=ACC<br/> “You saw a jaguar.”<br/> (2024-03-28(1)_sia)</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

*The reportative clitic* The reportative second-position clitic *=te* RPRT indicates that the speaker has only second-hand evidence; i. e. they didn’t experience the event themselves, but rather were told about it (13).

(13) REPORTATIVE EVIDENTIALITY

- kurága =te thési=ma áthe*  
shaman =RPRT jaguar=ACC see  
“A shaman saw a jaguar (I am told).” (2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

**INTERROGATIVE SENTENCES** Content questions are formed by fronting an indefinite expression (14). (For more on the morphology of indefinite expressions, see Section 3.7.) If a second-position clitic is present in an interrogative clause, it always immediately follows the indefinite expression (14a) (Dąbkowski, 2022, 2023b). A reportative WH-question

6 A’ingae pronouns encode both person and number. As such, they are glossed with both features: *ñá* 1SG, *ke* 2SG, *tise* 3SG, *ingi* 1PL, *keʔi* 2PL, and *tiseʔpa* 3PL. Second-position clitics are compatible with both singular and plural subjects. As such, they are glossed only with the person feature: *=ngi* 1, *=ki* 2, and *=tsû* 3.

may have one of two interpretations: either (i) the speaker relays someone else's question (i. e. the reportative scopes over the question), or (ii) the answer should draw on a third-person report (i. e. the question scopes over the reportative) (14b). The phenomena of WH-movement and pied-piping are further discussed in Section 3.7.

(14) CONTENT QUESTIONS

a. P2 CLITIC OPTIONAL

*jungué-sû=ma (=tsû) áthe*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC =3 see

"What did s/he see?"

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

b. REPORTATIVE WH-QUESTION

*jungué-sû=ma =nde áthe*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC =RPRT see

i. "(I was told to ask you:) What did s/he see?"

ii. "What did s/he see (according to what you were told)?"

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

*The polar interrogative clitic* Polar questions are marked by the polar question second-position clitic *=ti* YNQ (15).

(15) POLAR QUESTION

*kurága =ti thési=ma áthe?*

shaman =YNQ jaguar=ACC see

"Did a shaman see a jaguar?"

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

The reportative *=te* RPRT and the polar interrogative *=ti* YNQ are mutually incompatible (16). The compatibility between *=te* RPRT and *=ti* YNQ, on the one hand, and the subject clitics, on the other, varies with the subject person. The third-person subject clitic *=tsû* 3 is in complementary distribution with *=te* RPRT and *=ti* YNQ. This is to say, in sentences with a third-person subject, speakers reject *=te* RPRT and *=ti* YNQ alongside *=tsû* 3 (17). The first-person subject clitic *=ngi* 1 is compatible with *=te* RPRT and *=ti* YNQ, but its presence is optional (18). The second-person subject clitic *=ki* 2 follows *=te* RPRT and *=ti* YNQ obligatorily (even if the subject is independently expressed by a pronoun) (19).

(16) INCOMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *=TE* RPRT AND *=TI* YNQ

a. \**tíse =te=ti thési=ma áthe?*

3SG =RPRT=YNQ jaguar=ACC see

intended: "Did s/he (allegedly) see a jaguar?"

b. \**tíse =ti=te thési=ma áthe?*

3SG =YNQ=RPRT jaguar=ACC see

intended: "Did s/he (allegedly) see a jaguar?"

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

(17) THIRD-PERSON SUBJECT *=TSÛ* 3 INCOMPATIBLE WITH *=TE* RPRT, *=TI* YNQ

a. *tíse =te(\*=tsû) thési=ma áthe*

3SG =RPRT=3 jaguar=ACC see

"S/he saw a jaguar (I am told)."

b. *tíse =ti(\*=tsû) thési=ma áthe?*

3SG =YNQ=3 jaguar=ACC see

"Did s/he see a jaguar?"

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## (18) FIRST-PERSON SUBJECT =NGI 1 OPTIONAL WITH =TE RPRT, =TI YNQ

- a. *ñá =nde(=ngi) thési=ma áthe*      b. *ñá =ndi(=ngi) thési=ma áthe?*  
 1SG =RPRT=1    jaguar=ACC see      1SG =YNQ=1    jaguar=ACC see  
 “I saw a jaguar (I am told).”      “Did I see a jaguar?”

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## (19) SECOND-PERSON SUBJECT =KI 2 OBLIGATORY WITH =TE RPRT, =TI YNQ

- a. *ké =te\*(=ki) thési=ma áthe*      b. *ké =ti\*(=ki) thési=ma áthe?*  
 2SG =RPRT=2    jaguar=ACC see      2SG =YNQ=2    jaguar=ACC see  
 “You saw a jaguar (I am told).”      “Did you see a jaguar?”

(2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

**P2 CLITIC POSITIONS** The sentence-level clitics occur most commonly after the first full constituent (hence I refer to them as “second-position clitics”). Nonetheless, other positions are also attested in corpora and judged as grammatical in elicitation contexts (20).

## (20) P2 CLITICS COMPATIBLE WITH MOST PHRASES

- á?tse=ta*      (=tsû) *tsá?u=nga*    (=tsû) *ká?ni* (=tsû)  
 hummingbird=NEW =3    house=DAT =3    enter =3

“(The) hummingbird entered (the) house.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

A second-position clitic may not occur immediately adjacent to a constituent marked with the contrastive topic clitic =*ja* CNTR. If the *ja*-marked constituent is sentence-initial, the clitic may attach to one of the later constituents (21). For more on the contrastive topic =*ja* CNTR, see [Paragraph 4.5](#).

## (21) P2 CLITICS INCOMPATIBLE WITH =JA CNTR

- á?tse=ja*      (\*=tsû) *tsá?u=nga*    (=tsû) *ká?ni* (=tsû)  
 hummingbird=CNTR =3    house=DAT =3    enter =3

“(The) hummingbird entered (the) house.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

**DIRECTIVE SENTENCES** Most A’ingae directives, such as commands, requests, permissions, and prohibitions, are encoded using one of four verbal suffixes: the imperative -*ja* IMP (22a), the attenuated imperative -*kha* AIMP (22b), the permissive -*?se* PERM (22c), and the prohibitive -*jama* PROH (22d). A’ingae hortative sentences make use of a different morphosyntactic strategy—they are introduced by a stand-alone hortative particle *jinge(sû)* HORT, which selects for an infinitive clause (22e). Despite their matrix clausal status, directive sentences do not normally host second-position subject clitics.

## (22) DIRECTIVE SENTENCES INCOMPATIBLE WITH P2 CLITICS

## a. IMPERATIVE -JA IMP

*í-ʔnga-ja* (\*=ki) *khuímpa=ma*  
bring-AND-IMP =2 flint=ACC

“Go get (me) some flint!”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

## b. ATTENUATED IMPERATIVE -KHA AIMP

*kaʔni-ʔfá-kha* (\*=ki)  
enter-PLS-AIMP =2

“(Please) enter.”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

## c. PERMISSIVE -ʔSE PERM

*ké* (\*=ki) *va=ma* *isû-ʔse*  
2SG =2 DEM=ACC take-PERM

“You can take this.”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

## d. PROHIBITIVE -JAMA PROH

*ké* (\*=ki) *sumbú-jama*  
2SG =2 leave-PROH

“Don’t go out!”

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

## e. HORTATIVE JINGE(sû) HORT

*jínge* (\*=ngi) *kúʔfe-ye*  
HORT =1 play-INF

“Let’s play!” (2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

Imperatives with *-ja* IMP (23a) and prohibitives with *-jama* PROH (23b) can cooccur with the reportative *=te* RPRT to express a relayed directive. In these constructions, *=te* RPRT is followed by *=ki* 2 (in compliance with a morphotactic requirement, as shown in 19a). For more on directive morphology, see Paragraph 4.4.1.

## (23) REPORTED DIRECTIVES

## a. REPORTED IMPERATIVE

*ké* *=te=ki* *thátha-ʔnga-ja* *khúvi=ve*  
2SG =RPRT=2 look for-AND-IMP tapir=ACC2

“Go look for a tapir (they say)!”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## b. REPORTED PROHIBITIVE

*thatha-ʔngá-jama* *=nde=ki* *khúvi=ve*  
look for-AND-PROH =RPRT=2 tapir=ACC2

“Don’t go looking for a tapir (they

say)!” (2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## 3.4 Cosubordinate clauses

*Cosubordination* refers to a relation between two clauses where one clause is formally dependent on another (like a subordinate clause) but not embedded (like a coordinate clause) (van Valin, 1984). A’ingae has two cosubordinating morphemes that encode whether or not the subjects of two connected clauses are identical: the same-subject marker *-pa* SS (24a) and the different-subject marker *-si* DS (24b).

## (24) COSUBORDINATE CLAUSES

## a. SAME-SUBJECT -PA SS

*ápi=ma* *píʔpi-pa* *ísû*  
clay=ACC mold-ss take

“(S/he) made a clay pot and picked it up.” (AI, p. 13; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT -SI DS

*arápa* *pá-si* *=tsû* *ísû*  
chicken die-ds =3 take

“The chicken died and s/he picked it up.” (AI, p. 13; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

Cosubordinated clauses are temporally ordered (25). Specifically, the event denoted by the *pa-* or *si-*marked clause must at least begin before the onset of the event of the matrix clause (AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva, 2023) (25a-b). If the *pa-/si-*marked verb is imperfective, the event of the matrix clause is interpreted as simultaneous with the event of the cosubordinate clause (25c).

(25) COSUBORDINATION TEMPORALLY ORDERED

a. SUBSEQUENT EVENTS

*tíse =tsû arápa=ma fíʔthi-pa sáʔsa*  
 3SG =3 chicken=ACC kill-ss pluck  
 “S/he killed a chicken and plucked it.”  
 (2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

b. SUBSEQUENT EVENTS (REVERSED)

*#tíse =tsû arápa=ma sáʔsa-pa fíʔthi*  
 3SG =3 chicken=ACC pluck-ss kill  
 aberrant: “S/he plucked a chicken and killed it.” (2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

c. SIMULTANEOUS EVENTS

*tíse tsû kháya-ʔje-pa kúʔnu*  
 3SG =3 swim-IPFV-ss dive  
 “S/he was swimming and s/he dove (while swimming).”  
 (2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

Due to extensive pro-drop, A'ingae clauses may consist solely of the main predicate if the participants are contextually recoverable. This may give rise to long *clause chaining* constructions, where participant tracking is achieved solely or mainly through same- and different-subject marking (26). In clause chaining constructions, cosubordinate clauses precede the matrix clause, with the order of clauses iconically reflecting the order of events. Clause chaining is a common strategy for combining clauses in Amazonian languages (Aikhenvald, 2012; Sarvasy and Aikhenvald, 2024; van Gijn, Haude, and Muysken, 2011).

(26) CLAUSE CHAINING WITH *-PA* SS AND *-SI* DS

a. *átthe-pa púʔtaen-si búthi-in já*  
 see-ss shoot-DS run-MM go

“(A hunter) saw (a tapir); (the hunter) shot (at the tapir); (the tapir) ran away.”

literally: “(x) having seen, (x) having shot, (y) went running.”

(AIII, p. 8; 2024-02-15(1)\_sia)

b. *sánʔjan-mba ñuñá-mba áʔmbian-si kukáma jí-si Chávez-en*  
 dry-ss make-ss have-DS Spaniard come-DS buy-CAUS

“(A Cofán person) dried and prepared (a jaguar hide); a Spaniard came; (the Cofán person) sold (the Spaniard the hide).”

literally: “(x) having dried, (x) having made, (x) having had, a Spaniard<sub>y</sub> having come, (x) made (y) buy.”

(A4, p. 22; 2024-02-15(1)\_sia)

The story fragment in (26a) describes an interaction between a hunter and a tapir. Once the two participants have been established, they need not be overtly expressed; *-pa* ss and *-si* ds alert the reader as to the identity of the subject.

The fragment in (26b) comes after a description of a Cofán person killing and skinning a jaguar. A sequence of *pa*-connected verbs describes their preparations of the hide. The first *si*-marked clause signals a switch to the Spaniard as the subject. The second *si*-marked clause switches the subject again to the former protagonist.

The same-subject *pa*-marked clauses are selected by *kanse* ‘live’ in a habitual auxiliary construction (Fischer and Hengeveld, 2023; Hengeveld and Fischer, *in prep.*) (27). The meaning of the construction is similar to that of *-ye atesû* ‘INF know’ discussed in Section 3.5.2, and often translated using the present simple tense and adverbs such as “always” or “often.”

- (27) AUXILIARY *KANSE* ‘LIVE’ SELECTING FOR *-PA* SS  
*tise =tsû tsándie=ma sé?je-pa kánse*  
 3SG =3 man=ACC cure-ss live  
 “S/he (always) heals the man.” (2021-08-30\_sia)

A’ingae cosubordinate clauses are most often verb-final (24-27). However, non-verb-final word orders are often also grammatical, both for same-subject (28a) and different-subject (28b) cosubordinate clauses.

- (28) NON-VERB-FINAL COSUBORDINATION
- |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. SAME-SUBJECT CLAUSE</p> <p><i>pí?pi-pa ápi=ma, já</i><br/>         mold-ss clay=ACC go<br/>         “After making a clay pot, (s/he) left.”<br/>         (2024-04-12(1)_sia)</p> | <p>b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CLAUSE</p> <p><i>rúnda-?je =ngi, kú?i-si séje?pa=ma</i><br/>         wait-IPFV =1 drink-DS medicine=ACC<br/>         “I’m waiting because (s/he) drank<br/>         medicine.” (2025-09-05(1)_mll)</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### 3.4.1 P2 clitics and cosubordination

In same-subject subordination, the P2 clitic may appear as far left as adjacent to the first constituent (29a). In different-subject cosubordination, the clitic cannot appear left of the cosubordinate verb (29b).

- (29) CLITIC POSITION IN COSUBORDINATION
- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. SAME-SUBJECT CLAUSE</p> <p><i>ñá tsámpi=ni (=ngi) já-pa (=ngi) khúvi=ma áthe</i><br/>         1SG forest-LOC =1 go-ss =1 tapir=ACC see<br/>         “I went to the forest and saw a tapir.”<br/>         (2024-04-23(1)_sia)</p> | <p>b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CLAUSE</p> <p><i>tsámpi=ni (*=ki) já-si (=ki), áña?chu=ma ké shú?khaen</i><br/>         forest-LOC =2 go-DS =2 food=ACC 2SG cook<br/>         “When he went to the forest, you prepared food.”<br/>         (2024-04-23(1)_sia)</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### 3.4.2 Bridging constructions and adverbial clauses

In addition to clause chaining, the A'ingae switch reference markers *-pa ss* and *-si ds* may appear in two additional types of structure: bridging constructions and adverbial reason clauses (30). Bridging structures involve two independent sentences—the first sentence presents an event; the second sentence recapitulates that event with a switch-reference-marked verb and presents its narrative continuation (30a). Adverbial clauses express the cause or reason for the matrix clausal event (30b). In the adverbial use, *-pa ss* and *-si ds* are usually translated as “because.” Unlike clause-chaining structures (where the cosubordinate clause always precedes the matrix clause), adverbial clauses may precede or follow the matrix clause. For more on the various forms and functions of switch reference in A'ingae, see AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva (2023).

#### (30) OTHER FUNCTIONS OF *-PA SS* AND *-SI DS*

##### a. SENTENTIAL BRIDGING

úfa-ʔsû já-ʔya. já-pa tse síme=jan í-ʔya pûshésû=ma  
blow-SN go-ASSR go-SS STA evening=CNTR bring-ASSR woman=ACC

“He went hunting with a blowpipe. Having gone, in the evening he brought the woman.”

(AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva, 2023, p. 2; AnderBois and Silva, 2018, 20170806\_apicha\_pushesu\_BRCA, 2:06; 2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

##### b. REASON ADVERBIAL

ána-si kandéru jûʔrû tsáʔkhû=ve mé-chu-pa  
sleep-DS pot burn water=ACC2 PRIV-EN-SS

“When (he) was sleeping, the pot burned because there was no water inside.”

(AIV, p. 7; 2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

### 3.5 Subordinate clauses

A subordinate clause is a clause that cannot stand alone as an independent sentence; rather, it functions as a modifier or an argument of another (matrix) clause. In this section, I describe the basic morphosyntactic characteristics of A'ingae subordination, organized by finiteness. Section 3.5.1 discusses finite subordinate clauses. Section 3.5.2 discusses infinitive subordinate clauses.

#### 3.5.1 Finite subordination

In A'ingae matrix clauses, the finite verb may be bare or carry inflectional morphology (§3.3.1). This also holds for A'ingae finite subordinate clauses, which often may, but need not, overtly express categories such as aspect, reality, number, and polarity. Verbal subordinate clauses (discussed in Paragraph 3.5.1) are introduced with subordinating operators which directly encode their relation to the matrix clause. Nominal subordinations (discussed

in Paragraph 3.5.1) may be marked for case; their relation to the matrix clause varies accordingly—e. g. they can be subjects, verbal arguments, or miscellaneous adjuncts.

**VERBAL SUBORDINATION** A'ingae has a number of verbal subordinate clause types (31). They are used to introduce conditional antecedents (31a), adversatives (31b), precautioning adjuncts (31c), and others. A subordinate clause is marked by a subordinating morpheme which attaches to its main verb (e. g. *-saʔne* APPR, *-khen* TENT, *-ʔa* IF.SS, *-ʔni* IF.DS, *-ʔma* FRST). Many verbal subordinate clauses often precede the matrix clause (31a-b), although the opposite order is grammatical as well (31c).

(31) VERBAL SUBORDINATION TYPES

a. CONDITIONAL CLAUSE

*khúvi=ma áthe-ʔ-ta =ngi púʔtaen-ña*

tapir=ACC see-T-NEW =1 shoot-IRR

“If I see a tapir, I’ll shoot (it).”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

b. ADVERSATIVE CLAUSE

*khúvi=nga púʔtaen-ʔma =ngi déʔjian-mbi*

tapir=DAT shoot-FRST =1 hit-NEG

“I shot at the tapir, but I missed (it).”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

c. PRECAUTIONING CLAUSE

*phúraen kán-ʔñakha ámphí já-saʔne*

touch try-ITER fall go-APPR

“He kept feeling with his hand so as not to fall down.”

(AnderBois and Dąbkowski, 2020, 2025; 2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

Many types of verbal subordination function as adverbial modifiers of the matrix clause (31). However, some verbal subordinations are selected as clausal arguments of the matrix verb. For example, a tentative auxiliary construction, which corresponds to the English “try to (do sth),” involves a *khen*-marked clause introduced as a complement to the verb *tsun* ‘do’ (32).

(32) AUXILIARY *TSUN* ‘DO’ SELECTING FOR *-KHEN* TENT

*Tetéte =tsû ingi=ma fiʔthí-khen tsún-si =ngi dyú-pa jí-pa vá=ni kánʔjen-ʔfa*

Waorani =3 1PL=ACC kill-TENT do-DS =1 fear-SS come-SS DEM=LOC be.ANIM-PLS

“The Tetetes tried to kill us, so we came to stay here out of fear.”

(AC2, pp. 9, 50; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

**SUBORDINATE NOMINALIZATION** In addition to regular verbal subordination, A'ingae allows for subordinate nominalizations. As such, it patterns with other Amazonian languages, which often employ nominalization as a strategy for subordination (Overall and Wojtylak, 2018).

The A'ingae nominalized subordinations include clauses formed with one of the dedicated causal nominalizers, such as the event nominalizer *-ʔchu* EN (33a) (which serves as a com-

mon and versatile subordination strategy), or the subject nominalizer *-ʔsû* SN (33b). In addition, nominal subordination can be formed with some of the classifiers, such as the place classifier *-ʔthi* PLC (33c), or by simply a case marker, such as the locative *-ni* LOC (33d). Regardless of the particular strategy, the nominalizing morpheme always attaches to the inflected verb of the subordinate clause.

(33) SUBORDINATE NOMINALIZATION TYPES

a. CLAUSAL EVENT NOMINALIZATION

*páña =ngi kéʔi sú-ʔfa-ʔchu-ma*

hear =1 2PL say-PLS-EN-ACC

“I understood what y’all said.”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

b. CLAUSAL SUBJECT NOMINALIZATION

*ñá=ma atesi-án-ʔsû -tsû avûjá-tshi*

1SG=ACC learn-CAUS-SN =3 rejoice-ADJ

“My teacher is happy.”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

c. PLACE CLASSIFIER NOMINALIZATION

*ja-yí =ngi dûʔshû=ndekhû tíse máma=me túʔi rúnda-ʔje-ʔfa-ya-ʔthi-nga*

go-PRSP =1 child=PL.ANIM 3SG mom=ACC2 tomorrow wait-IPFV-PLS-IRR-PLC-DAT

“I’m going to the place where the children will tomorrow be waiting for their mom.”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

d. LOCATIVE CASE NOMINALIZATION

*ja-yí =ngi dúʔshû atésû-ni*

go-PRSP =1 child learn-LOC

“I’m going where the child learned.”

(2022-07-05(1)\_jxm)

The nominalized subordinate clauses combine elements of verbal and nominal structure. Their verbal character is seen in that many of them can carry characteristic verbal infections (e. g. *-ʔfa* PLS in 33a; *-ʔje* IPFV, *-ʔfa* PLS, *-ya* IRR in 33c) and have overtly expressed unmarked subjects, accusative-marked objects, and regular clausal adjuncts (33). Their nominal character is evidenced by the fact that they often have noun-like meanings (“teacher” in 33b; “the place where ...” in 33c), can be marked with regular case morphemes (e. g. *-ma* ACC in 33a; *-nga* DAT in 33c; *-ni* LOC in 33d), and—correspondingly—function as subjects (33b), objects (33a), or adjuncts (33c-d) of the matrix verb. The position of the nominalized clause in a sentence corresponds to its argument or adjunct function.

In matrix clauses, A’ingae word order is relatively free. Similarly to cosubordinate clauses (§3.4), finite subordinate clauses are typically verb-final (31-33). However, other word orders (e. g. with post-verbal objects) are also grammatical in many types of verbal (34a) and nominal (34b) subordinate clauses.

## (34) NON-VERB-FINAL SUBORDINATION

## a. VERBAL SUBORDINATION

*putáenʔgu=ma áʔmbian kachái-saʔne thési=ma*  
 rifle=ACC have meet-APPR jaguar=ACC

"I have a rifle in case I meet a jaguar."

(2024-04-12(1)\_sia)

## b. NOMINAL SUBORDINATION

*páña =ngi kurága áthe-ʔchu-ma thési=ma*  
 hear =1 shaman see-EN-ACC jaguar=ACC

"I heard that a shaman saw a jaguar."

(2020-12-07\_sia)

## 3.5.2 Infinitive subordination

In addition to finite subordinate clauses, A'ingae allows for infinitive subordination. The verb of an infinitive subordinate clause is marked with *-ye* INF. Infinitive clauses may have a variety of functions, which include being selected as an argument of a lexical verb, such as *inʔjan* 'want' (35a), occupying the subject position of a stative predicate (35b), and introducing rationale adjuncts (35c-d). A rationale clause whose subject differs from the subject of the matrix clause may (but need not) be introduced by the switch-reference purpose conjunction *kúintsû/kaentsû* PURP.DS (35d). A rationale cause whose subject is the same as the subject of the matrix clause may not be introduced by *kúintsû/kaentsû* PURP.DS (35c). Infinitive subordinations are not necessarily verb-final, and may be followed by adjuncts and arguments, such as objects (35a,c).

## (35) INFINITIVE SUBORDINATE CLAUSES

a. SELECTED BY *INʔJAN* 'WANT'

*inʔjan =ngi án-ñe ávû=ma*  
 want =1 eat-INF bocachico=ACC

"I want to eat bocachico."

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## b. INFINITIVE SUBJECT

*ñú-tshe án-ñe =tsû injénge*  
 good-ADV.ADJ eat-INF =3 needed

"Eating healthy is necessary."

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## c. SAME-SUBJECT RATIONALE CLAUSE

*séma-ʔjen =ngi (\*kúintsû) ganá-ñe kurífiʔndi=ma*  
 work-IPFV =1 PURP.DS earn-INF money=ACC

"I am working to earn money."

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## d. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT RATIONALE CLAUSE

*séma-ʔjen =ngi (kúintsû) ké ñúʔfa-ye*  
 work-IPFV =1 PURP.DS 2SG rest-INF

"I am working so that you can rest."

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

In addition, infinitive clauses are selected for by some aspectual auxiliary verbs (36). In combination with an infinitival complement, the verb *atesû* ‘know’ expresses habitual actions, which can often be translated as the Spanish or English present simple (36a). The imperfective form of the verb *tsun* ‘do’ expresses the prospective aspect, often translated with the Spanish *ir a* (*hacer*) ‘to be going to (do sth)’ (36b).

(36) ASPECTUAL AUXILIARY VERBS SELECTING FOR -YE INF

a. COMPLEMENT OF HABITUAL *ATESÛ* ‘KNOW’

*tsá =tsû tsámpi=nga ána-ñe atésû*

ANA =3 forest=DAT sleep-INF know

“They (said tapirs) sleep in the forest.” (AV, p. 33; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

b. COMPLEMENT OF PROSPECTIVE *TSUN-ʔJEN* ‘DO-IPFV’

*ñá=nda =ngi pá-ye tsún-ʔjen*

1SG=NEW =1 die-INF do-IPFV

“I’m going to die.” (AC2, pp. 14, 36; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

Finally, the infinitival -ye INF also has a matrix-clausal function, where it is used to express future reference (37b). This function is similar to that of the irrealis -ya IRR (37a), discussed further in Paragraph 4.3. Some speakers identify the *ye*-future as more proximate or certain, and the *ya*-future as more distant or uncertain.

(37) EXPRESSIONS OF THE FUTURE

a. DISTANT YA-FUTURE

*ñá (=ngi) panzá-ya*

1SG =1 hunt-IRR

“I will hunt.”

(distant/uncertain future)

(2022-03-18\_sia)

b. PROXIMATE YE-FUTURE

*ñá (\*=ngi) panzá-ye*

1SG =1 hunt-INF

“I will hunt.”

(proximate/certain future)

literally: “I (am) to hunt.”

(2022-03-18\_sia)

Second-position clitics are always associated with matrix clauses (§3.3.1), never with subordinate clauses (§3.5.3). The irrealis future clauses may host a second-position clitic (37a), while the infinitive future clauses may not (37b). This suggests that the matrix-clausal infinitive future construction is a case of insubordination (Evans, 2007)—a stand-alone, though formally subordinate, clause.

### 3.5.3 P2 clitics and subordination

The second-position clitic always encodes the person feature of the matrix clausal subject; it may never express the person feature of a subordinate subject (38). This generalization holds of all types of subordination, including finite verbal (38a), finite nominal (38b), and infinitive subordinations (38c).

## (38) MATRIX SUBJECT PERSON EXPRESSED BY P2 CLITIC

## a. VERBAL SUBORDINATION

*thési jí-ʔni-nda* (=ngi/\*=tsû) *ñá bûthú-ya*  
 jaguar come-IF.DS-NEW =1/=3 1SG run-IRR

“If a jaguar comes, I will run.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## b. SUBORDINATE NOMINALIZATION

*ñá páña* (=ngi/\*=ki) *kéʔi sú-ʔfa-ʔchu-ma*  
 1SG hear =1/=2 2PL say-PLS-EN-ACC

“I understood what y’all said.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## c. INFINITIVE SUBORDINATION

*ké séma-ʔjen* (=ki/\*=tsû) *dûʔshú=ndekhû án-ʔfa-ye*  
 2SG work-INF =2/=3 child=PL.ANIM eat-PLS-INF

“You are working so that (your) children can eat.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

The restrictions on the placement of second-position clitics in subordinate clauses recapitulate those seen in cosubordinate clauses (§3.4). If the subordinate clause precedes the matrix clause and their subjects coincide, the second-position clitic can appear as far left as the first constituent of the subordinate clause (39-41a). However, suppose the subject of the subordinate clause differs from the matrix clause’s subject. In that case, the P2 clitic can appear only as far left as the right edge of the subordinate clause (39-41b). In other words, a second-position clitic may not appear within the subordinate clause whose subject it does not match. This generalization holds of finite verbal (39), finite nominal (40), and infinitive (41) subordinations.

## (39) CLITIC POSITION IN VERBAL SUBORDINATIONS

## a. SAME-SUBJECT ANTECEDENT

*khúvi=ma* (=ngi) *áthe-ʔ-ta* (=ngi) *púʔtaen-ñá*  
 tapir=ACC =1 see-T-NEW =1 shoot-IRR

“If I see a tapir, I’ll shoot (it).”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT ANTECEDENT

*thési* (\*=ngi) *jí-ʔni-nda* (=ngi) *bûthú-ya*  
 jaguar =1 come-IF.DS-NEW =1 run-IRR

“If a jaguar comes, I will run.”

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

## (40) CLITIC POSITION IN SUBORDINATE NOMINALIZATIONS

## a. SAME-SUBJECT EVENT NOMINAL

*thési=ma* (=ngi) *kachái-ya-ʔchu-ma* (=ngi) *ñá dyúju*  
 jaguar=ACC =1 meet-IRR-EN-ACC =1 1SG be afraid

“I’m afraid of encountering a jaguar.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT EVENT NOMINAL

*thési* (\*=ngi) *ña=ma áthe-ya-ʔchu-ma* (=ngi) *ña dyúju*  
 jaguar =1 1SG=ACC see-IRR-EN-ACC =1 1SG be afraid

"I'm afraid that a jaguar might see me."

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## (41) CLITIC POSITION IN INFINITIVE SUBORDINATIONS

## a. SAME-SUBJECT RATIONALE

*áñaʔchu=ma* (=ki) *áʔmbian-ñe* (=ki) *ké séma-ʔjen*  
 food=ACC =2 have-INF =2 2SG work-IPFV

"You are working to have food."

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT RATIONALE

*dûʔshû=ndekhû* (\*=ki) *án-ʔfa-ye* (=ki) *ké séma-ʔjen*  
 child=PL.ANIM =2 eat-PLS-INF =2 2SG work-INF

"You are working so that (your) children can eat."

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## 3.6 Verb serialization

Serial verbs are monoclausal constructions that consist of two or more verbs without any overt subordinating, coordinating, or otherwise linking morphology (Aikhenvald, 2018; Lovestrand, 2021). Prototypically, all verbs within a serial verb construction describe one event (Aikhenvald, 2018).

A'ingae serial verb constructions (SVCs) can express a variety of complex events, as long as a discourse-cohesive interpretation can be supplied (Kalpande, 2024). Attested relations among individual verbs in a serial construction include *narration*, where each subsequent verb presents a temporally posterior event (42a), *result*, which combines a cause and an effect (42b), *continuation*, where the serialized verbs present different aspects of one event (42c), and *elaboration*, where the first verb introduces an event and the following verbs supply additional details (42d). For more on the A'ingae serial verb constructions and an analysis thereof couched within Discourse Coherence Theory (DCT) (e.g. Asher and Lascarides, 2003; Jasinskaja and Karagjosova, 2020; Kehler, 2001), see Kalpande (2024).

## (42) VERB SERIALIZATION

## a. NARRATION RELATION

*tíse =tsû khúí* *jángi já*  
 3SG =3 lie down get up go

"S/he lied down, got up, and left."

(2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## b. RESULT RELATION

*tshéʔtshe fíʔthi-ʔya tise púshe=ma*  
 beat kill-ASSR 3SG wife=ACC

"He beat his wife to death." (Kalpande, 2024, p. 49; AnderBois and Silva, 2018, 20170807\_flor\_flanca\_chiste\_RJCL, 1:25; 2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## C. CONTINUATION RELATION

*tsún-mba jápa sétha jángi kúʔi-pa án*  
do-ss go-ss chant get up drink-ss eat

“Then they (held an ayahuasca ceremony, i. e. repeatedly) chanted, got up, and drank, and (then) ate.” (Kalpande, 2024, p. 49; AnderBois and Silva, 2018, 20170731\_yaje3\_MM, 0:35; 2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## d. ELABORATION RELATION

*tíse =tsû tsúí já*  
3SG =3 walk come

“S/he came walking.” (2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

Within a verb series, the non-terminal verbs can be inflected with voice suffixes, e. g. the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR (43a), verbal inflectional suffixes, e. g. the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV (43b-d), or discourse suffixes, e. g. the new topic *-ta* NEW (43d).

## (43) VERB SERIALIZATION

## a. RECIPROCAL NON-TERMINAL

*tíseʔpa afá-khu jí-ʔfa*  
3SG speak-RCPR come-PLS

“They came arguing.” (2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

## b. IMPERFECTIVE NON-TERMINAL

*káni kúse =te=ngi ñá ána-ʔjen tsúí*  
yesterday night =RPRT=1 1SG sleep-IPFV walk

“Last night I sleepwalked (I am told).” (2024-03-28(1)\_sia)

## c. IMPERFECTIVE NON-TERMINAL

*tsún-si tsé-ne-jan fúndu-ʔje jí-ña*  
do-DS STA-ELAT-CNTR scream-IPFV come-PRSP

“Then he was coming from there screaming.” (C4, p. 28; 2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## d. DISCOURSE-MARKED NON-TERMINAL

*fúndu-ʔje-ta jí*  
scream-IPFV-NEW come

“(S/he) came screaming” (2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

Situation-level inflection, such as the negative *-mbi* NEG (44), and clause-type inflection, such as the prohibitive *-jama* PROH (45), are ungrammatical on non-terminal verbs in an SVC (44b, 45b), i. e. they may appear only on the last verb (44a, 45a). Situation-level and clause-type inflectional morphology always scopes over all the verbs within an SVC (44a, 45a).

## (44) SITUATION-LEVEL INFLECTION AND SVCs

## a. -MBI NEG SCOPES OVER ENTIRE SVC

*tíse =tsû fúndu-ʔje jí-mbi*

3SG =3 scream-IPFV come-NEG

“(S/he) didn’t come screaming.”

not: “\*(S/he) was screaming (but) didn’t come.”

(2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## b. -MBI NEG UNGRAMMATICAL ON NON-TERMINAL VERB

*\*tíse =tsû fúndu-ʔje-mbi jí*

3SG =3 scream-IPFV-NEG come

intended: “(S/he) came without screaming.”

(2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## (45) CLAUSE-TYPE INFLECTION AND SVCs

## a. -JAMA PROH SCOPES OVER ENTIRE SVC

*fúndu-ʔje jí-jama*

scream-IPFV come-PROH

“Do not come screaming.”

not: “\*(You)’re screaming (but) do not come.”

(2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## b. -JAMA PROH UNGRAMMATICAL ON NON-TERMINAL VERB

*\*fúndu-ʔje-jama jí*

scream-IPFV-PROH come

intended: “Come without screaming.”

(2025-08-28(1)\_mll)

## 3.7 Indefinites and WH-questions

In this section, I briefly discuss A’ingae indefinites, which have both existential and interrogative uses (§3.7.1), comment on their morphological structure (§3.7.2), and describe the basic facts of A’ingae word order in WH-questions, including WH-fronting, WH-extraction, and pied-piping (§3.7.3).

## 3.7.1 Interpretations of indefinites

A’ingae has a class of polyfunctional expressions which I gloss as indefinite (ID). They have both declarative existential (46a-c, 47a-b, 48a-b) and WH-question uses (46d, 47c, 48c). The two functions do not show any morphological differences (e. g. neither requires additional suffixation). Nonetheless, I will use phrases such as “WH-word” and “WH-constituent” when referring specifically to their interrogative uses.

## (46) USES OF JUNGUE-SÛ IDSB-ATTR “SOMETHING,” “ANYTHING,” “WHATEVER,” “WHAT”

## a. INDEFINITE EXISTENTIAL

*án-mbi =ngi jugué-sû=ma*

eat-NEG =1 IDSB-ATTR=ACC

“I didn’t eat anything.”

(2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## b. WIDENED DOMAIN

*án-mbi =ngi jugué-sû=ma=?khe*  
eat-NEG =1 IDSB-ATTR=ACC=ADD

"I didn't eat anything at all." (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## c. FREE CHOICE

*jungué-sû=?khe =tsû fûite-?chu-ya*  
IDSB-ATTR=ADD =3 help-EN-IRR

"Anything will be helpful." (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## d. WH-INTERROGATIVE

*jugué-sû=ma =tsû án*  
IDSB-ATTR=ACC =3 eat

"What did s/he eat?" (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## (47) USES OF MA-JAN IDSL-CNTR "SOMEONE," "ANYONE," "WHOEVER," "WHO"

## a. FREE RELATIVE

*tshái-ya =ngi má-jan ña ánkhe?sû=ma án-?chu-ma*  
punch-IRR =1 IDSL-CNTR 1SG food=ACC eat-EN-ACC

"I will punch (the one) who has eaten my food." (2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

## b. EVER-FREE RELATIVE

*tshái-ya =ngi má-jan=ñi=?khe ña ánkhe?sû=ma án-?chu-ma*  
punch-IRR =1 IDSL-CNTR=EXCL=ADD 1SG food=ACC eat-EN-ACC

"I will punch whoever has eaten my food." (2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

## c. WH-INTERROGATIVE

*má-jan =tsû án ña ánkhe?sû=ma*  
IDSL-CNTR =3 eat 1SG food=ACC

"Who ate my food?" (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## (48) USES OF MÍ-NGA-NI IDDG-DAT-LOC "SOMETIME," "ANYTIME," "WHENEVER," "WHEN"

## a. CONDITIONAL

*mí-nga-ni jí-?ni-nda avûjá-tshi-ya*  
IDDG-DAT-LOC come-IF.DS-NEW rejoice-ADJ-IRR

"I will be happy when they return. (Their arrival will be the cause of my happiness.)" (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## b. UNCONDITIONAL

*mí-nga-ni jí-?ni-?khe avûjá-tshi-ya*  
IDDG-DAT-LOC come-IF.DS-ADD rejoice-ADJ-IRR

"Whenever they return, I will be happy. (I am happy now, too; their arrival won't be the cause of my happiness.)" (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## C. WH-INTERROGATIVE

*mí-nga-ni*      =*tsû jí-ya*

IDDG-DAT-LOC =3    COME-IRR

“When will s/he come?”

(2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

The declarative existential uses appear in a variety of constructions which may be translated to English as, for example, indefinite existentials (46a), free relatives (47a), and heads of clausal adjuncts (48a). The declarative existential uses may be accompanied by the additive focus morpheme *-/ʔkhe* ADD, which extends or adds variation to the set of possible referents/situations. Possible translations of the indefinite *ʔkhe*-constructions include domain-widening expressions such as “at all” (46b), free choice *any* (46c), free relatives with *-ever* (47b), and unconditionals (48b). The interrogative uses are available only when the indefinite expression is fronted (46d, 47c, 48c). WH-movement is discussed further in Section 3.7.3.

## 3.7.2 Morphology of indefinites

All of the A’ingae indefinites contain one of the three indefinite roots: the substance indefinite *jungue-* IDSB (49), the selection indefinite *ma-* IDSL (50), or the degree indefinite *mi-* IDDG (51).<sup>7</sup> Below, a few indefinites are presented and given a (probable diachronic) morphological decomposition. The decomposition should not be taken to mean that new indefinites can be derived productively, as their meanings are often opaque. The translations approximate the interpretations of indefinites in interrogative contexts.

(49) SUBSTANCE INDEFINITES WITH *JUNGUE-* IDSB

- |                     |                     |                       |
|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| a. <i>jungué-sû</i> | b. <i>jungué-je</i> | c. <i>jungué-si-e</i> |
| IDSB-ATTR           | IDSB-IPFV           | IDSB-ATTR-ADV         |
| “what (kind)?”      | “what for?”         | “what for?”           |

(50) SELECTION INDEFINITES WITH *MA-* IDSL

- |                  |                 |                 |                 |                   |
|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| a. <i>má-jan</i> | b. <i>má-ñi</i> | c. <i>má-ni</i> | d. <i>má-ki</i> | e. <i>má-ʔkan</i> |
| IDSL-CNTR        | IDSL-EXCL       | IDSL-LOC        | IDSL-DRN        | IDSL-SML          |
| “who?”           | “how many?”     | “where?”        | “what day?”     | “like what?”      |

(51) DEGREES INDEFINITES WITH *MI-* IDDG

- |                  |                  |                   |                     |                       |
|------------------|------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| a. <i>mí-kun</i> | b. <i>mí-nga</i> | c. <i>mí-ngae</i> | d. <i>mí-nga-ni</i> | e. <i>mí-nge-tshi</i> |
| IDDG-?           | IDDG-DAT         | IDDG-MANN         | IDDG-DAT-LOC        | IDDG-?-ADJ            |
| “do what?”       | “like what?”     | “how?”            | “when?”             | “how much?”           |

## 3.7.3 WH-fronting, WH-extraction, and pied-piping

In WH-questions, the indefinite expression is always fronted. If a second-position clitic is present, it must appear immediately after the fronted constituent (52a). The P2 clitic cannot

<sup>7</sup> The labels for substance, selection, and degree have been adopted from Borman (1976); the extent to which they correctly reflect the basic or historical meaning of each given root is not clear.

surface to the right of an element other than the WH-constituent (52b). Other material may be fronted to the left of the WH-constituent if the WH-constituent carries the P2 clitic (52c). In the rest of this section, second-position clitics are underlined.

(52) WH-MOVEMENT

a. WH-CONSTITUENT ADJACENT TO P2 CLITIC

*má-ni-ngae      tsû kurága      já?*

IDSL-LOC-MANN =3 shaman go

“Where did the shaman go?”

(2022-06-18\_sia)

b. WH-MOVEMENT OBLIGATORY

\**kurága      tsû má-ni-ngae      já?*

shaman =3 IDSL-LOC-MANN go

intended: “Where did the shaman go?”

(2024-04-23(1)\_sia)

c. MOVEMENT PAST WH-CONSTITUENT

*kurága      má-ni-ngae      tsû já?*

shaman IDSL-LOC-MANN =3 go

“Where did the shaman go?”

(2024-04-23(1)\_sia)

In addition to WH-movement, A'ingae also shows *pied-piping* structures, where the fronted constituent contains, but is not identical to, the WH-word (Ross, 1967, 1986). Pied-piping is often viewed as a repair strategy used when extracting the WH-word is disallowed (Heck, 2004, 2008, 2009). This appears to adequately characterize some of the A'ingae pied-piping structures. For example, while the extraction of a WH-possessor from a noun phrase (53a) and a WH-constituent from a finite subordinate clause (54a) is banned, pied-piping by possessor (53b) pied-piping of the finite subordinate clause (54b) are licit.

However, in some other structures, both strategies are grammatical. For example, in infinitive subordination (55) and cosubordination (56), both extraction and pied-piping are allowed. This shows that in A'ingae, the availability of pied-piping does not correlate with a ban on WH-extraction. For more on A'ingae pied-piping, see Dąbkowski (2022).

(53) WH-POSSESSOR

a. EXTRACTION ILLICIT

\**má-jan-mbe      tsû án      ánkhe?sû=ma?*

IDSL-CNTR-BEN =3 eat food=ACC

intended: “Whose food did s/he eat?”

(2024-04-23(1)\_sia)

b. PIED-PIPING LICIT

*má-jan-mbe      ánkhe?sû=ma      tsû án?*

IDSL-CNTR-BEN food=ACC =3 eat

“Whose food did s/he eat?”

(2022-03-02\_sia)

## (54) WH-WORD IN FINITE SUBORDINATION

## a. EXTRACTION ILLICIT

\**má-jan*    *ɛki búthu-ʔje ké=ma áthe-saʔne?*

IDSL-CNTR 2    run-IPFV 2SG=ACC see-APPR

intended: “You’re running so that *who* doesn’t see you?” (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## b. PIED-PIPING LICIT

*má-jan*    *ké=ma áthe-saʔne ɛki búthu-ʔje?*

IDSL-CNTR 2SG=ACC see-APPR ɛ2 run-IPFV

“You’re running so that *who* doesn’t see you?” (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## (55) WH-WORD IN INFINITIVE SUBORDINATION

(Dąbkowski, 2024b)

## a. EXTRACTION LICIT

*jungué-sû=ma ɛki ñá ké=nga afé-ye ínʔjan?*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC ɛ2 1SG 2SG=DAT give-INF want

“What do you want me to give you?” (2022-03-15\_sia)

## b. PIED-PIPING LICIT

*jungué-sû=ma ñá ké=nga afé-ye ɛki ínʔjan?*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC 1SG 2SG=DAT give-INF ɛ2 want

“What do you want me to give you?” (2022-03-15\_sia)

## (56) WH-WORD IN COSUBORDINATION

## a. EXTRACTION LICIT

*jungué-sû=ma ɛki shúʔkhaen-si búthu*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC ɛ2 cook-DS    run

“What did (s/he) cook so that you could run?” (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## b. PIED-PIPING LICIT

*jungué-sû=ma shúʔkhaen-si ɛki búthu*

IDSB-ATTR=ACC cook-DS    ɛ2 run

“What did (s/he) cook so that you could run?” (2024-04-24(1)\_sia)

## 4 VERBAL MORPHOSYNTAX

This section focuses on A’ingae verbal morphology, including the semantic contributions of particular suffixes, their relationship to syntactic structure, and their morphotactic restrictions. A’ingae verbs can be (derived and) richly inflected with a variety of suffixes, organized in a templatic fashion. The slots of the A’ingae verbal template can be grouped into four main categories: voice morphology, verbal inflectional morphology, situation-level morphology, and cause-level functional morphology. A verb showcasing suffixes from each of the four major categories is given in (57).

## (57) FOUR CATEGORIES OF A'INGAE VERBAL MORPHEMES

[ [ [ [ [ *kufi* -*án* ]<sub>VceP</sub> -*ʔjen -ngi* ]<sub>AspP</sub> -*ʔfa -mbi* ]<sub>TP</sub> -*ʔni -nda* ]<sub>CP</sub>  
 play -CAUS -IPFV -VEN -PLS -NEG -IF.DS -NEW

“now<sub>NEW</sub>, if<sub>IF</sub> (they<sub>PLS</sub>) do not<sub>NEG</sub> come<sub>VEN</sub> to be<sub>IPFV</sub> making<sub>CAUS</sub> play, (someone  
 else<sub>DS</sub>) ...” (2024-06-18(1)\_mll)

## INFORMATION STRUCTURAL SUFFIXES

(§4.5)

(xiii) TOPIC: -*ta* NEW, -*ja* CNTR(xii) ADDITIVITY: -*ʔkhe* ADD(xi) EXCLUSIVITY: -*yi* EXCL

## CLAUSE-TYPE SUFFIXES

(§4.4)

(x) CLAUSE TYPE

MATRIX: -*ja* IMP, -*kha* AIMP, -*ʔse* PERM, -*jama* PROH, -*ʔya* ASSRCOSUBORDINATE: -*pa* SS, -*si* DSSUBORDINATE: -*saʔne* APPR, -*khen* TENT,(-*ʔa* IF.SS,) -*ʔni* IF.DS, -*ʔma* FRST

## SITUATION-LEVEL SUFFIXES

(§4.3)

(ix) TENSE: (-*ʔ* T)(viii) POLARITY: -*mbi* NEG(vii) REALITY/FINITENESS: -*ya* IRR, -*ye* INF(vi) SUBJECT NUMBER: -*ʔfa* PLS

## VERBAL INFLECTIONAL SUFFIXES

(§4.2)

(v) ASSOC MOTION: -*ʔngi* VEN, -*ʔnga* AND(iv) ASPECT: -*ʔje* IPFV, -*ji* INGR, -*kha* VDM, -*ʔñakha* ITER

## VOICE SUFFIXES

(§4.1)

(iii) PASSIVE: -*ye* PASS(ii) RECIPROCAL: -*khu* RCPR(i) CAUSATIVE: -*ña/-an/-en* CAUS

## VERBAL ROOT

(o) VERBAL ROOT: √

Table 1: Morphological template of the A'ingae verb (building on Dąbkowski, 2024b, 2025e)

The full morphological template of the A'ingae verb is given in Table 1. The verbal root is at the bottom, and successive slots of the morphological template are above it.<sup>8</sup> Section 4.1

<sup>8</sup> The morphemes given in parentheses (-*ʔ* T, -*ʔa* IF.SS) are overt feature-bundle realizations observed in specific syntactic contexts. In other environments, those same feature bundles are phonologically null. Also note that

describes the A'ingae voice suffixes, including the causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS, the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR, and the passive *-ye* PASS. Section 4.2 focuses on verbal inflection, including the aspectual and associated motion suffixes. Section 4.3 looks at situation-level inflection, including marking for subject number, reality status, polarity, and finiteness. Section 4.4 describes the clause-type suffixes which characterize matrix, cosubordinate, and subordinate clauses. Section 4.5 briefly discusses information structural morphemes.

#### 4.1 Voice morphology

A'ingae has three voice suffixes: the valence-increasing causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS, the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR, and the valence-decreasing passive *-ye* PASS. In this section, I briefly describe their common uses and interpretations.

**THE CAUSATIVE** The suffix that attaches closest to the root is the causative. The causative has three allomorphs which are phonologically conditioned: *-ña* CAUS attaches to monosyllables (58a); *-an* CAUS attaches to polysyllabic roots ending in *e*, *i*, or *û* (58b-d); *-en* CAUS appears on polysyllables ending in *a* or *u* (58e-f) (Dąbkowski, 2024b; Fischer and Hengeveld, 2023; Hengeveld and Fischer, *in prep.*). The allomorph *-ña* CAUS constitutes a separate syllable; the allomorphs *-an* and *-en* CAUS form a diphthong with the root-final vowel.<sup>9</sup>

- (58) ALLOMORPHS OF *-ÑA/-AN/-EN* CAUS (Dąbkowski, 2024b)
- |                                                             |                                                              |                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. / <i>phi. -ña</i> /<br>[ <i>phi.ña</i> ]<br>sit -CAUS    | b. / <i>átthe -an</i> /<br>[ <i>á.thian</i> ]<br>see -CAUS   | c. / <i>káti -an</i> /<br>[ <i>ká.tian</i> ]<br>throw -CAUS |
| d. / <i>aʔjû -an</i> /<br>[ <i>áʔ.jian</i> ]<br>vomit -CAUS | e. / <i>panza -en</i> /<br>[ <i>pá.nzaen</i> ]<br>hunt -CAUS | f. / <i>bûthu -en</i> /<br>[ <i>bú.thuen</i> ]<br>run -CAUS |

The causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS increases the valence of the verb by one. For example, the stative verb *iʔndû* 'be fermented' is intransitive (59a). When causativized with *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS, a new argument is introduced as a subject; the entity undergoing fermentation is now introduced as a regular direct object (59b).

- (59) VALENCE-INCREASING *-ÑA/-AN/-EN* CAUS
- |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                              |                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| a. <i>tshétsheʔpa -tsû iʔndû</i><br>chicha =3 be fermented<br>"The chicha is fermented."<br>(2022-07-12(1)_jxm) | b. <i>tíse -ʔtsû iʔndi-an</i><br>3SG =3 be fermented-CAUS<br>"S/he fermented chicha."<br>(2022-07-12(1)_jxm) | <i>tshétsheʔpa=ma</i><br>chicha=ACC |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|

Table 1 captures the relative order of verbal morphemes, but does not represent additional co-occurrence restrictions among them. Some of the co-occurrence restrictions are discussed throughout the rest of this paper.

<sup>9</sup> The vowel alternations seen in roots in the surface forms in (58b,d) are caused by regular phonological processes which turn vowel sequences into licit diphthongs. For more on A'ingae diphthongal processes, see Dąbkowski (2023c, 2025a).

The causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS is the only productive verbalizing suffix, capable of deriving verbs from nouns (60a-b) and other syntactic categories (60c).

(60) VERBS PRODUCTIVELY DERIVED WITH *-ÑA/-AN/-EN* CAUS

- |                                                                                     |                                                                               |                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>tsáu?</i> <i>-ña</i><br>house -CAUS<br>“build a house”<br>(2024-08-30(1)_mll) | b. <i>búnta</i> <i>-en</i><br>button -CAUS<br>“button”<br>(2023-12-13(1)_sia) | c. <i>sín</i> <i>-ña</i><br>black -CAUS<br>“blacken”<br>(2023-12-13(1)_sia) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**THE RECIPROCAL** The next slot in the verbal morphological template is the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR. When attached to transitive verbs (61a), the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR often appears instead of the direct object and encodes that fact that the subject is both the agent and the undergoer of an action (61b).

(61) VALENCE-DECREASING *-KHU* RCPR

- |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>tíse?pa =tsû sé?je-?fa á?i=ma</i><br>3PL =3 cure-PLS person=ACC<br>“They cured people.”<br>(2023-12-15(1)_sia) | b. <i>tíse?pa =tsû seje-khú-?fa</i><br>3PL =3 cure-RCPR-PLS<br>“They cured each other.”<br>(2023-08-15(2)_lxl) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

However, the argument removed by the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR may replace arguments other than the directed object. In (62b), *-khu* RCPR expresses the reciprocity between the story-tellers and the audience, not between story-tellers and the direct object of story-telling, i. e. the stories (62a).

(62) NON-CORE ARGUMENT REPLACED BY *-KHU* RCPR

- |                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| a. <i>tíse?pa =tsû kúndase-?fa kundáse?pa=ma dú?shû=nga</i><br>3PL =3 tell-PLS story=ACC child=DAT<br>“They told the story to children.”<br>(2023-12-15(1)_sia) |  |
| b. <i>tíse?pa =tsû kundáse?pa=ma kundase-khú-?fa</i><br>3PL =3 story=ACC tell-RCPR-PLS<br>“They told stories to each other.”<br>(2023-12-15(1)_sia)             |  |

The suffix *-khu* RCPR may also express collective or accompanied actions. Such readings are the only ones available in contexts which do not allow for reciprocal readings, e. g. with verbs used intransitively (63).

(63) INTRANSITIVE VERBS WITH *-KHU* RCPR

- a. *setsá-en-si síʔnge únfeʔmba=nga kútsa-pa túyaʔkaen síʔnge kú-si pá-ye*  
 be lit-CAUS-DS fire smoke=DAT suffocate-ss and fire heat-DS die-INF  
*tsún-ʔjen-mba áʔi=ngae fûndu-khú-ʔfa*  
 do-IPFV-SS person=MANN scream-RCPR-PLS

“After (the Cofán) set (the place where the demons lived) on fire, (the demons) were suffocating because of the smoke, and the fire was burning them, and when they were about to die, they started screaming in A’ingae.”

(B&CU, p. 129; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

- b. *tíse tsá-ʔka-en tsún-ʔjen-ʔni-jan sambíri=ja pá-ye bûthu-khú-ʔfa*  
 3SG ANA-SML-ADV do-IPFV-IF.DS-CNTR sardine=CNTR die-INF run-RCPR-PLS

“When s/he was doing that, the fish started to flee because they were dying.”

(B&CU, p. 82; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

**THE PASSIVE** The last voice suffix is the passive *-ye* PASS. The passive attaches to transitive verbs (64a) and promotes the direct object to subject (64b). The demoted subject may be optionally introduced as a dative adjunct.

(64) VALENCE-DECREASING *-YE* PASS

- a. *kurága =tsû ña chán=ma séʔje* b. *ña chán =tsû sejé-ye (kurága=nga)*  
 shaman =3 1SG mother=ACC cure 1SG mother =3 cure-PASS shaman=DAT  
 “A shaman cured my mother.” “My mother was cured (by a  
 (2023-12-15(1)\_sia) shaman).” (2023-12-15(1)\_sia)

The three valence-changing suffixes are mutually compatible and may appear on the same verb (65). There is only one allowed order for the three suffixes—the causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS comes first, followed by the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR and finally the passive *-ye* PASS.

(65) ORDER OF *-ÑA/-AN/-EN* CAUS, *-KHU* RCPR, *-YE* PASS

*tíse =ʔtsû akhepa-en-khú-ye*  
 3SG =3 forget-CAUS-RCPR-PASS

“S/he was made to forget with another person.”

(2022-01-31\_jxm)

## 4.2 Verbal inflectional morphology

The voice suffixes are followed by the aspectual and associated motion suffixes. I refer to the latter two categories as *verbal inflection* because they can appear only on verbal predicates. In this, they differ from the *situation-level* suffixes (to be discussed in Section 4.3) and *clause-level* morphemes (to be discussed in Sections 4.4–5) which may attach to both verbal and nominal predicates.

## 4.2.1 Aspect

A'ingae has four aspectual suffixes: the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV, the ingressive *-ji* INGR, the verbal diminutive *-kha* VDM, and the iterative *-ʔñakha* ITER. Here, I briefly describe the meaning of each aspectual suffix, and some of their morphotactic restrictions.

**THE IMPERFECTIVE** The most common aspectual suffix is the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV. The imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV presents an action as ongoing or without a reference to its completion. Unembedded verbs marked with *-ʔje* IPFV receive present tense continuous interpretations (66).

(66) INTERPRETATIONS OF *-ʔje* IPFVa. *akhépa-ʔje*

forget-IPFV

Eng. “(S/he)’s forgetting.”

Sp. “Está olvidando.”

(2021-09-16\_sia)

b. *tíse =ʔtsû kachái-ʔje thési=ma*

3SG =3 meet-IPFV jaguar-ACC

Eng. “S/he’s encountering a jaguar.”

Sp. “Él está encontrando un tigre.”

(2022-07-22(1)\_jxm)

**THE INGRESSIVE** The ingressive *-ji* INGR presents an action as about to be started or in the process of being started. Consultants commonly translate ingressive verbs using the Spanish constructions *estar por* (*hacer*) ‘to be about to (do sth)’ (67a) and *estar a punto de* (*hacer*) ‘to be at the point of (doing sth)’ (67b).

(67) INTERPRETATIONS OF *-ji* INGRa. *tíse =tsû rúʔnda-ji*

3SG =3 wait-INGR

Eng. “S/he’s about to wait.”

Sp. “Él está por esperar.”

(2023-08-24(2)\_sia)

b. *tíse =ʔtsû ána-jin*

3SG =3 sleep-INGR

Eng. “S/he’s at the point of sleeping.”

Sp. “Él está a punto de dormir.”

(2022-07-01(1)\_jxm)

**THE VERBAL DIMINUTIVE** The verbal diminutive *-kha* VDM expresses an action that is short, done quickly, or incompletely. Consultants commonly translate diminutive verbs using the Spanish *un poco* ‘for a bit’ (68a), *un ratito* ‘for a little while’ (68b), *y salió, y se fue* ‘and left’ (68c), or *rápidamente* ‘briefly’ (68d).

(68) INTERPRETATIONS OF *-kha* VDMa. *tíse =tsû kufé-kha*

3SG =3 play-VDM

Eng. “S/he played for a bit.”

Sp. “Él jugó un poco.”

(2023-08-28(5)\_dmu)

b. *tíse =tsû kaní-kha*

3SG =3 enter-VDM

Eng. “S/he came in for a little while.”

Sp. “Él entró un ratito.”

(2023-08-28(5)\_dmu)

- |                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>c. <i>tíse =tsû kufé-kha</i><br/> 3SG =3 play-VDM<br/> Eng. “S/he played and left.”<br/> Sp. “Él jugó y se fué.”<br/> (2023-08-21(3)_eol)</p> | <p>d. <i>tíse =ʔtsû afasé-kha</i><br/> 3SG =3 criticize-VDM<br/> Eng. “S/he briefly criticized.”<br/> Sp. “Él criticó rápidamente.”<br/> (2021-09-15_2_jxm)</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**THE ITERATIVE** The iterative *-ʔñakha* ITER expresses an action repeated several times. Iterative verbs are commonly translated with Spanish *poco a poco* ‘little by little’ (69a), *seguir* (*haciendo*) ‘keep on (doing sth)’ (69b), *estar* (*haciendo*) *mientras viene* ‘be (doing sth) as one comes’ (69c), and *estar* (*haciendo*) *y* (*haciendo*) ‘to be (doing sth) again and again’ or (*hacer*) *un rato y venir* ‘(do sth) for a bit and come’ (69e). The iterativity encoded by *-ʔñakha* ITER may favor a plural interpretation of the object (plurality is typically not overtly marked on inanimate noun phrases) (69d). Due to the presence of the morpheme-initial glottal stop, *-ʔñakha* ITER shows the same stress behavior as the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV.

(69) INTERPRETATIONS OF *-ʔÑAKHA* ITER

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>tíse =tsû í-ʔñakha</i><br/> 3SG =3 bring-ITER<br/> Eng. “S/he’s bringing little by little.”<br/> Sp. “Él está trayendo poco a poco.”<br/> (2020-12-09_sia)</p>                                                                                                            | <p>b. <i>tíse =tsû fétha-ʔñakha</i><br/> 3SG =3 open-ITER<br/> Eng. “S/he keeps on opening.”<br/> Sp. “Él siga abriendo.”<br/> (2021-08-25_sia)</p>                                      |
| <p>c. <i>tíse =tsû tshái-ʔñakha</i><br/> 3SG =3 hit-ITER<br/> Eng. “S/he is hitting as s/he comes.”<br/> Sp. “Él está pegando mientras viene.”<br/> (2024-04-12(1)_sia)</p>                                                                                                        | <p>d. <i>ñá =ngi fétha-ʔñakha súmbuʔthi=ma</i><br/> 1SG =1 open-ITER door=ACC<br/> Eng. “I am opening the doors.”<br/> Sp. “Yo estoy abriendo las puertas.”<br/> (2022-07-14(2)_rgq)</p> |
| <p>e. <i>tíse =tsû rúnda-ʔñakha</i><br/> 3SG =3 wait-ITER<br/> Eng. “S/he’s waiting again and again; waits for a bit and comes; waits for a bit and comes.”<br/> Sp. “Él está esperando y esperando; espera un rato y viene; espera un rato y viene.”<br/> (2023-08-24(2)_sia)</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                          |

The four aspectual suffixes (imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV, ingressive *-ji* INGR, verbal diminutive *-kha* VDM, and iterative *-ʔñakha* ITER) are compatible with the preceding voice morphology, including the causative *-ñá/-an/-en* CAUS (70a), the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR (70b), and the passive *-ye* PASS (70c). The aspectual suffixes occupy the same slot in the morphological template. As such, they are mutually exclusive—at most one aspectual suffix may attach to a verb (71).

(70) ASPECTUAL SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH VOICE MORPHOLOGY

- |                                                                                |                                                                           |                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>akhepá-en-ʔjen</i><br/> forget-CAUS-IPFV<br/> (2023-08-16(4)_eol)</p> | <p>b. <i>afa-khú-ji</i><br/> speak-RCPR-INGR<br/> (2025-08-18(1)_mll)</p> | <p>c. <i>akhepá-ye-ʔñakha</i><br/> forget-PASS-ITER<br/> (2023-08-16(4)_eol)</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## (71) ASPECTUAL SUFFIXES MUTUALLY INCOMPATIBLE

- |                                                                  |                                                                     |                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. * <i>afa-ʔje-ji</i><br>speak-IPFV-INGR<br>(2023-08-24(2)_sia) | b. * <i>afa-ji-ʔñakha</i><br>speak-INGR-ITER<br>(2023-08-24(2)_sia) | c. * <i>afa-kha-ʔje</i><br>speak-VDM-IPFV<br>(2023-08-24(2)_sia) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|

Note that some of the translations provided for the latter two suffixes (the iterative *-ʔñakha* ITER and the verbal diminutive *-kha* VDM) suggest that their meanings (may) involve a motion associated with the action of the verb (68c, 69c,e). This is consistent with a general pattern observed in South America, where many verbal affixes combine aspectual and associated motion meanings (Guillaume, 2016). Two additional suffixes that convey the semantics of strictly associated motion are discussed below.

## 4.2.2 Associated motion

A'ingae has two associated motion/verbal deixis suffixes: the venitive *-ʔngi* VEN and the andative *-ʔnga* AND. Like the aspectual suffixes, the associated motion suffixes can attach only to verbs (i. e. *-ʔngi* VEN and *-ʔnga* AND are not compatible with nominal predicates).

**THE VENITIVE** The venitive *-ʔngi* VEN is used to express that the action took place at the location of speaking or involved movement to the location of speaking (72).

## (72) VENITIVE -ʔNGI VEN

*shávu=ni jí-pa ûfákhuʔkhu=ma í-ʔngi-pa já*  
canoe=LOC come-SS blowgun=ACC bring-VEN-SS go

"I came to the site of the canoe to bring the blowgun and left again."

(AV, p. 40; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

**THE ANDATIVE** The andative *-ʔnga* VEN is used to express that the action took place or involved movement away from the location of speaking (73).

## (73) ANDATIVE -ʔNGA AND

*í-ʔnga-pa kán-ʔni-jan táyu pájin útha*  
bring-AND-SS look-IF.DS-CNTR already dead be on top

"I took (the blowgun) there, and when I saw (the monkey), it had gotten stuck (in the tree and was) already dead."

(AV, p. 40; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

Both associated suffixes have dynamic and static readings. This is to say, the venitive *-ʔngi* VEN can have a venitive ("come to do sth") or a static venitive ("do sth here") interpretation (74a). Likewise, the andative *-ʔnga* AND can have an andative ("go to do sth") or a static andative ("do sth there") interpretation (74b).

(74) INTERPRETATIONS OF *-ʔngi* VEN AND *-ʔnga* AND

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>tíse =ʔtsû sái-ʔngi</i><br/> 3SG =3 pull-VEN<br/> Eng. “S/he came to harvest (yuca).”<br/> Sp. “Él vino a sacar (la yuca).”<br/> Eng. “S/he harvested (yuca) here.”<br/> Sp. “Él sacó (la yuca) aquí.”<br/> (2022-07-07(1)_jxm)</p> | <p>b. <i>tíse =tsû sái-ʔnga</i><br/> 3SG =3 pull-AND<br/> Eng. “S/he went to harvest (yuca).”<br/> Sp. “Él se fue a sacar (la yuca).”<br/> Eng. “S/he harvested (yuca) there.”<br/> Sp. “Él sacó (la yuca) allá.”<br/> (2024-02-20(1)_sia)</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

The venitive *-ʔngi* VEN and the andative *-ʔnga* AND are compatible with the preceding voice morphology, including the causative *-ña/-an/-en* CAUS (75a), the reciprocal *-khu* RCPR (75b), and the passive *-ye* PASS (75c). The associated motion suffixes are compatible with imperfective aspectual affix *-ʔje* IPFV (76).<sup>10</sup> However, *-ʔngi* VEN and *-ʔnga* AND are not compatible with the other three aspectual suffixes: the ingressive *-ji* INGR (77a), the verbal diminutive *-kha* VDM (77b), or the iterative *-ñakha* ITER (77c).

## (75) ASSOCIATED MOTION SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH VOICE MORPHOLOGY

- |                                                                         |                                                                            |                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>iná-en-ʔnga</i><br/> cry-CAUS-AND<br/> (2025-09-23(2)_mll)</p> | <p>b. <i>afá-khu-ʔngi</i><br/> speak-RCPR-VEN<br/> (2025-09-23(2)_mll)</p> | <p>c. <i>athé-ye-ʔnga</i><br/> see-PASS-AND<br/> (2025-09-23(2)_mll)</p> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|

(76) ASSOCIATED MOTION SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH *-ʔje* IPFV

- |                                                                        |                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>séje-ʔje-ngi</i><br/> cure-IPFV-VEN<br/> (2021-09-16_sia)</p> | <p>b. <i>akhépa-ʔje-nga</i><br/> forget-IPFV-AND<br/> (2021-09-16_sia)</p> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## (77) ASSOCIATED MOTION SUFFIXES INCOMPATIBLE WITH OTHER ASPECTUAL MORPHEMES

- |                                                                            |                                                                              |                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>a. <i>*seje-ji-ʔngi</i><br/> cure-INGR-VEN<br/> (2023-08-28(3)_sia)</p> | <p>b. <i>*akhépa-kha-ʔngi</i><br/> cure-VDM-VEN<br/> (2023-08-28(3)_sia)</p> | <p>c. <i>*afase-ñakha-(ʔ)ngi</i><br/> offend-ITER-VEN<br/> (2025-09-23(2)_mll)</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 4.3 Situation-level morphology

Verbal inflection is followed by the situation-level morphology. The situation-level suffixes include the plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS, the irrealis *-ya* IRR, the negative *-mbi* NEG, and the infinitive *-ye* INF. Unlike the verbal inflectional suffixes, some of the morphemes discussed in this section may also attach to nominal predicates (hence the distinction between *verbal* and *situation-level* morphology).<sup>11</sup>

<sup>10</sup> After the imperfective *-ʔje* IPFV, the venitive *-ʔngi* VEN and the andative *-ʔnga* AND lose their glottal stops and are realized as *-ngi*, *-nga*. For an analysis of this fact, see Dąbkowski (2024b, 2025d).

<sup>11</sup> Additionally, the boundary between the two suffix categories corresponds to a boundary between A'ingae's two major phonological strata—while the root, voice suffixes, and verbal inflectional suffixes belong to the *inner* morphophonological domain, the situation-level suffixes (as well as the clause-level morphemes discussed in the following sections) belong to the *outer* domain. For a description and analysis of A'ingae morphophonology, see Dąbkowski (2021c, 2024b, 2025d, 2026b).

**THE PLURAL SUBJECT** The suffix *-ʔfa* PLS is often used to express the plurality of the subject (78a-b). Nonetheless, *-ʔfa* PLS is optional, and need not be used even with unambiguously plural subjects (78c).

(78) PLURAL SUBJECT *-ʔfa* PLS

a. MATRIX SUBJECT PLURALITY WITH *-ʔfa* PLS

*án naní-mba kúse-si ána-ʔfa*

eat finish-ss night-DS sleep-PLS

“After they finished eating, it got dark, and they went to sleep.”

(AV, p. 7; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

b. SUBORDINATE SUBJECT PLURALITY WITH *-ʔfa* PLS

*tsún-mba dûʔshú=ndekhû=ma mandá-ʔfa kúintsû inajampáña-ʔfa-ye jungué-sû=ma*

do-ss child=PL.ANIM=ACC order-PLS PURP.DS ask-PLS-INF IDSB-ATTR=ACC

=nde dyúju

RPRT be afraid

“Then the children were told to go ask what he feared.”

(B&CU, p. 19; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

c. SUBORDINATE SUBJECT PLURALITY WITHOUT *-ʔfa* PLS

*ñáʔme kúnda-ya-ʔchu-ve-ja ushá-ʔfa-mbi =ngi, ma-ján=ndekhû=ta*

truly let know-IRR-EN-ACC2-CNTR be able-PLS-NEG =1 IDSL-CNTR=PL.ANIM=NEW

=ngi kuenzá=ndekhû=ni já-ʔfa káentsû kúndase-ye

=1 elder=PL.ANIM=LOC go-PLS PURP.DS tell-INF

“And, to tell the truth, we didn’t know how to respond. Some of us went to the elders so that they could tell us.”

(Criollo and Blanco Pisabarro, 1992, pp. 11, 65; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS is compatible with all previous suffixes, including voice (79a), aspectual (79b), and associated motion (79c) morphology.

(79) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-ʔfa* PLS AND TEMPLATICALLY PRECEDING MORPHEMES

a. *ina-khú-ʔfa*

cry-RCPR-PLS

(2023-08-15(2)\_lx1)

b. *afe-jí-ʔfa*

give-INGR-PLS

(2023-08-16(2)\_rxu)

c. *káti-ʔnga-ʔfa*

throw-AND-PLS

(2025-09-23(2)\_m11)

**THE IRREALIS** When used in a matrix clause, the irrealis *-ya* IRR commonly receives a future interpretation (80a). However, other uses testify to the suffix’s broader irrealis meaning, including a variety of specific irrealis constructions. For example, *-ya* IRR can be used when asking for permission (80b) and in hypotheticals (80c). The suffix *-ya* IRR can also mark the consequent of a gnomic conditional (80d). In a combination with the event nominalizer *-ʔchu* EN, the irrealis *-ya* IRR expresses necessity (80e).

## (80) FUNCTIONS OF -YA IRR

## a. FUTURE REFERENCE

*ñá=nda =ngi utifá-pa jí-ya*  
1SG=NEW =1 CROWN-SS come-IRR

“I will come wearing a headband.”  
(B&C, p. 170; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## b. REQUEST FOR PERMISSION

A: *isú-ya =ti=ngi* B: *jújú isú-?se*  
take =YNQ=1 yes yes take-PERM

“A: May I pick it up?” “B: Please do.”  
(AII, p. 25; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## c. HYPOTHETICAL

*táyu =ti pá-ya*  
already =YNQ die-IRR

“Would he die already?”  
(2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## d. CONDITIONAL CONSEQUENT

*tsá?khû kú-?ta guá?thi-ya*  
water warm up-T-NEW boil-IRR

“If warmed up, water boils.”  
(2021-09-15\_1\_rgq)

## e. NECESSITY

*tíve=ma gíya-tshe =tsû utishí-ya-?chu*  
hand=ACC clean-ADV.ADJ =3 wash hands-IRR-EN

“(One/you) must wash hands thoroughly.” (AV, p. 27; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The irrealis *-ya* IRR is compatible with all previous suffixes, including voice morphology (81a), verbal inflection morphology (81b), as well as the plural subject *-?fa* PLS (81c).

## (81) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN -YA IRR AND TEMPLATICALLY PRECEDING MORPHEMES

a. *pasá-en-ñá*

pass-CAUS-IRR

(2022-07-19(1)\_jxm)

b. *búthu-?je-ya*

run-IPFV-IRR

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

c. *áfa-?fa-ya*

speak-PLS-IRR

(2023-08-24(1)\_nec)

**THE INFINITIVE** The suffix *-ye* INF encodes infinitive clauses, unmarked for reality status. The A'ingae *ye*-marked verbs appear in a variety of contexts, including as stative predicate subjects (82a), complements of verbs such as *in?jan* ‘want’ (82b) or *usha* ‘be able’ (82c), rationale clauses (82d), and proximate future (82e). For more on the functions and syntax of infinitival *ye*-clauses, see Section 3.5.2.

## (82) FUNCTIONS OF -YE INF

## a. STATIVE PREDICATE SUBJECT

*án-ñe-?nda =tsû injéng-e-?chu*  
eat-INF-T-NEW =3 needed-EN

“Eating is important.”  
(2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

b. COMPLEMENT OF *IN?JAN* ‘WANT’

*tú?i =ngi já-ye in?jan*  
tomorrow =1 go-INF want

“I want to leave tomorrow.”  
(AC2, pp. 14, 36; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

c. COMPLEMENT OF *USHA* ‘BE ABLE’

*ké =ki úsha kínse-tshe kánse-ye*  
2SG =2 be able health-ADV.ADJ live-INF

“You can live a healthy life.” (P&C, p. 5; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## d. RATIONALE CLAUSE

*kúse-pa tsáu?-ña-ʔfa tué-ʔthi=nga, ána bithá-pa pá-ʔchu=ma tái-ye*  
 night-ss house-CAUS-PLS same-PLC=DAT sleep wake up-ss die-EN=ACC pick up-INF  
 “When it got dark, they built a shelter there, so that they could go to sleep,  
 wake up, and collect (more fish) that had died (overnight).”

## e. PROXIMATE FUTURE

(AV, p. 12; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

*charápa dúsúchu-ʔje-si, áthe-ʔta kánʔjen-mba jí-ye*  
 turtle lay egg-IPFV-DS see-T-NEW stay-ss come-INF

“If we see that the turtles are laying eggs, we will stay for a while and then  
 return.” (AV, p. 13; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The infinitive *-ye* INF is compatible with voice (83a), aspectual (83b), and associated motion (83c) morphology. Additionally, the suffix is compatible with the plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS (84a), but not the irrealis *-ya* IRR (84b).

(83) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-YE* INF AND MOST TEMPLATICALLY PRECEDING MORPHEMES

- |                                                               |                                                                |                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>giyá-en-ñe</i><br>clean-CAUS-INF<br>(2023-12-04(1)_sia) | b. <i>khaya-khá-ye</i><br>swim-AIMP-INF<br>(2025-09-23(2)_mll) | c. <i>séje-ʔngi-ye</i><br>cure-VEN-INF<br>(2023-08-28(3)_sia) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|

(84) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-YE* INF AND *-ʔfa* PLS, BUT NOT *-ya* IRR

- |                                                                 |                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>áʔmbian-ʔfa-ye</i><br>have-PLS-INF<br>(2022-06-18(1)_sia) | b. <i>*ja-ya-ye</i><br>go-IRR-INF<br>(2024-03-04(1)_sia) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|

THE NEGATIVE The negative suffix *-mbi* NEG expresses negation (85).

(85) NEGATIVE *-MBI* NEG

*tsá-ʔma injámaʔchu=ma=jan án-mbi*  
 ANA-FRST heart=ACC=CNTR eat-NEG

“But he didn’t eat the heart.” (B&CU, p. 191; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

The negative *-mbi* NEG is compatible with most preceding suffixes, including voice (86a), aspectual (86b), and associated motion (86c) morphology. It is also compatible with the plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS (87a) and the irrealis *-ya* IRR (87b), but not with the infinitive *-ye* INF (87c).

(86) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-MBI* NEG AND MOST PRECEDING MORPHEMES

- |                                                               |                                                             |                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>seje-yé-mbi</i><br>cure-PASS-NEG<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | b. <i>phi-jí-mbi</i><br>sit-INGR-NEG<br>(2022-08-09(1)_jxm) | c. <i>kháya-ʔnga-mbi</i><br>swim-AND-NEG<br>(2025-09-23(2)_mll) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|

(87) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-MBI* NEG AND *-ʔfa* PLS, *-ya* IRR, BUT NOT *-ye* INF

- |                                                              |                                                            |                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>afé-ʔfa-mbi</i><br>give-PLS-NEG<br>(2023-08-14(2)_eol) | b. <i>jí-ya-mbi</i><br>come-IRR-NEG<br>(2024-06-20(2)_mll) | c. <i>*khaʔya-mbi-ye</i><br>swim-NEG-INF<br>(2025-09-23(2)_mll) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|

Since the negative *-mbi* NEG is not compatible with the infinitive *-ye* INF (88a), in order to express the semantics of a negative infinitive “to not (do sth),” a periphrasis is used: A negated (*-mbi* NEG) verb is adverbialized (*-e* ADV) and introduced as a complement to the dummy auxiliary verb *kan* AUX. (The auxiliary *kan* AUX is homophonous with the lexical verb *kan* ‘look.’ However, in its auxiliary use, *kan* AUX is semantically vacuous.) The auxiliary *kan* AUX then takes on the infinitival ending (*-ye* INF) (88b).

(88) INCOMPATIBILITY OF \*-YE-MBI INF-NEG AND PERIPHRAISIS

- |                                               |                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| a. -YE INF AND -MBI NEG INCOMPATIBLE          | b. INCOMPATIBILITY CIRCUMVENTED     |
| <i>*setsa-yé-mbi-ye</i>                       | <i>setsa-yé-mbe kán-ñe</i>          |
| infect-PASS-NEG-INF                           | infect-PASS-ADV.NEG AUX-INF         |
| intended: “in order not to catch (a disease)” | “in order not to catch (a disease)” |
| (2024-02-20(1)_sia)                           | (BC&C, p. 163; 2024-02-20(1)_sia)   |

THE BOUNDARY-MARKING GLOTTALIZATION When information structural morphemes (new topic *-ta* NEW, contrastive topic *-ja* CNTR, exclusive focus *-yi* EXCL; §4.5) attach directly to a verb which is (optionally) inflected with morphemes up to and including situation-level morphology, a glottal stop *-ʔ* T is realized between the last verbal morpheme and first information structural marker (89).<sup>12</sup>

(89) MORPHOSYNTACTIC BOUNDARY MARKED WITH -ʔ T

- |                                                                   |                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| a. GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -TA NEW                                  | b. GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -JA CNTR     |
| <i>sése jí-ʔ-ta =tsû án-ñá</i>                                    | <i>atésû =ngi guáʔthi-an-ñe-ʔ-jan</i> |
| papagayo come-T-NEW =3 eat-IRR                                    | know =1 boil-CAUS-INF-T-CNTR          |
| “If the papagayo comes, it will eat.”                             | “I (habitually) boil.”                |
| (2024-06-10(1)_mll)                                               | (2024-06-11(2)_mll)                   |
| c. GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -YI EXCL                                 |                                       |
| <i>tsá-ʔka-en kánse-ʔfa-ʔ-yi-ta =ki ñuáʔme shaká-ʔfa-ya-mbi</i>   |                                       |
| ANA-SML-ADV live-PLS-T-EXCL-NEW =2 truly lack-PLS-IRR-NEG         |                                       |
| “Only if you live like this, you will truly not lack (anything).” |                                       |
| (Thessalonians 4:12; 2024-06-07(1)_mll)                           |                                       |

When an information structure (IS) marker is attached to a verb that has been overtly (co)subordinated, e. g. with the different-subject *-si* DS (90a) or the tentative *-khen* TENT (90b), or nominalized, e. g. with the bounded space classifier *-khû* BND (90c), no glottal stop is realized between the verb and the IS marker. For more on the boundary marking glottalization, see Dąbkowski (2025b,e).

<sup>12</sup> Dąbkowski (2025b,e) analyzes that glottal stop as a T-head, which is overly realized only when linearly adjacent to a discourse marker, hence the gloss *-ʔ* T.

## (90) MORPHOSYNTACTIC BOUNDARY NOT MARKED WITH -ʔ T

## a. GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -JA NEW

*kéʔi atesú-ʔfa-mbi-si-ja kéʔi=nga teváen-mbi =ngi*

2PL KNOW-PLS-NEG-DS-CNTR 2PL=DAT write-NEG =1

“I do not write to you because you do not know (the truth).”

(1 John 2:21; 2024-06-10(1)\_mll)

## b. NO GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -YI CNTR

*iʔná-khen-ñi =ngi vána-ʔjen*

cry-TENT-EXCL =1 suffer-IPFV

“I am struggling only to cry.”

(2025-07-17(1)\_mll)

## c. NO GLOTTALIZATION BEFORE -YI EXCL

*dúʔshû tise máma=me rúʔnda-ya-khû-ta =tsû ránde*

child 3SG mom=ACC2 wait-IRR-BND-NEW =3 large

“The room where a child will wait for their mom is large.” (2025-07-17(1)\_mll)

## 4.4 Clause-type morphology

Clause-level suffixes can be divided into three categories based on the status of the clause in which they appear: matrix-clausal, cosubordinate, and subordinate.

## 4.4.1 Matrix-clausal morphology

Matrix clausal morphology includes four directive suffixes: the imperative *-ja* IMP, the attenuated imperative *-kha* AIMP, the permissive *-ʔse* PERM, and the prohibitive *-jama* PROH, as well as the assertive suffix *-ʔya* ASSR.

**THE DIRECTIVES** The imperative *-ja* IMP (91a) and the attenuated imperative *-kha* AIMP (91b) express commands or requests. Their meanings are similar; speakers sometimes translate the former as a stronger command and the latter as an attenuated request. The permissive *-ʔse* PERM expresses permission (91c). The prohibitive *-jama* PROH expresses prohibition (91d).

## (91) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES -JA IMP, -KHA AIMP, -ʔSE PERM, AND -JAMA PROH

## a. IMPERATIVE -JA IMP

*í-ʔnga-ja khuímpa=ma théʔthu=ve ñuñá-ñe*

bring-AND-IMP flint=ACC tooth=ACC2 make-INF

“Go get me some flint so I can make teeth.” (B&C, p. 60; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

b. ATTENUATED IMPERATIVE -*kha* AIMP

*ñá=nga áin jí-saʔne inʔjan-ʔfá-kha*  
 1SG=DAT dog come-APPR think-PLS-AIMP

“Make sure the dog doesn’t come after me.”

(Hengeveld and Fischer, [in prep.](#) 20040202-FASC-Panzaye-3-030;  
 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

c. PERMISSIVE -ʔ<sub>SE</sub> PERM

A: *isû-ya =ti=ngi* B: *jûjû isû-ʔse*  
 take =YNQ=1 yes yes take-PERM

“A: May I pick it up?” “B: Please do.” ([AII](#), p. 25; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

d. PROHIBITIVE -*jama* PROH

*tetête fíʔthi-ʔfa-saʔne, fuéʔkhu pá-saʔne, sumbú-jama*  
 savage kill-PLS-APPR one die-APPR leave-PROH

“Lest the savages kill and you die, don’t go out.”

([B&C](#), p. 172; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The four directive suffixes (-*ja* IMP, -*kha* AIMP, -ʔ<sub>se</sub> PERM, -*jama* PROH) are compatible with voice ([92](#)), aspect ([93](#)), and associated motion ([94](#)) suffixes. They are compatible with the plural subject -ʔ<sub>fa</sub> PLS ([95](#)), but not with the other situation-level suffixes ([96](#)).

## (92) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH VOICE SUFFIXES

- |                                                               |                                                                 |                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>áfa-en-jan</i><br>speak-CAUS-IMP<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | b. <i>afa-khú-ʔse</i><br>speak-RCPR-PERM<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | c. <i>athe-yé-jama</i><br>see-PASS-PROH<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|

## (93) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH ASPECTUAL SUFFIXES

- |                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>fetha-jí-ja</i><br>open-INGR-IMP<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | b. <i>fetha-ʔjé-kha</i><br>open-IPFV-AIMP<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | c. <i>fetha-ʔñakhá-jama</i><br>open-ITER-PROH<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|

## (94) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH ASSOCIATED MOTION SUFFIXES

- |                                                               |                                                                  |                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>áfa-ʔngi-ja</i><br>speak-VEN-IMP<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | b. <i>afa-ʔngá-jama</i><br>speak-VEN-PROH<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | c. <i>thátha-ʔnga-ʔse</i><br>search-AND-PROH<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|

(95) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES COMPATIBLE WITH -ʔ<sub>FA</sub> PLS

- |                                                               |                                                                |                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>kánse-ʔfa-ja</i><br>live-PLS-IMP<br>(2024-02-15(1)_sia) | b. <i>áfa-ʔfa-ʔse</i><br>speak-PLS-PERM<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | c. <i>kaʔni-ʔfá-jama</i><br>enter-PLS-PROH<br>(2023-08-15(3)_mll) |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|

## (96) DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES INCOMPATIBLE WITH OTHER SITUATION-LEVEL SUFFIXES

- |                                                                 |                                                                  |                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>*afa-ya-jama</i><br>speak-IRR-PROH<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | b. <i>*kaʔni-ñe-ʔse</i><br>enter-INF-PERM<br>(2025-09-12(1)_mll) | c. <i>*kaʔni-mpi-ja</i><br>enter-NEG-IMP<br>(2024-02-20(1)_sia) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|

Consequently, an imperative suffix cannot combine with the negative *-mbi* NEG directly to express prohibition (96c). Instead, prohibitions are expressed synthetically with *-jama* PROH (91d, 97a) or periphrastically. The latter strategy forms a negative imperative (i. e. prohibitive) expression in a way similar to negative infinitives: A negated (*-mbi* NEG) verb is adverbialized (*-e* ADV) and introduced as a complement to the dummy auxiliary verb *kan* AUX. The auxiliary *kan* AUX then takes on an imperative ending (e. g. *-ja* IMP) (97b).

(97) TWO PROHIBITIVE STRATEGIES

a. SYNTHETIC

*dyú-jama*

fear-PROH

“Be not afraid!”

(2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

b. PERIPHRASTIC

*dyú-mbe kán-jan*

fear-ADV.NEG AUX-IMP

“Be not afraid!”

(Genesis 15:1; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

THE ASSERTIVE Finally, the assertive *-ʔya* ASSR can appear on verbs in indicative sentences (98a). While its exact meaning has so far escaped precise description, *-ʔya* ASSR is compatible with a range of suffixes used in assertions, including the future *-ya* FUT (98b) and the negative *-mbi* NEG (98c).

(98) ASSERTIVE *-ʔya* ASSR

a. IN A DECLARATIVE SENTENCE

*tsá-ʔma =nde fáeʔkhu=ja yáje=ma kúʔi-pa áthe-ʔya kháʔi=ʔkhú*

ANA-FRST =RPRT one=CNTR ayahuasca=ACC drink-SS see-ASSR others=INS

*kundasé-khu-ʔje-ʔfa-ʔchu=ma*

tell-RCPR-IPFV-PLS-EN-ACC

“But when one (shaman) drank ayahuasca, he would see them talking with others.”

(B&CU, p. 209; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

b. COMPATIBLE WITH *-ya* IRR

*tsé-ni ansúndé-pa =ki upí-ʔtshe súsú-ʔtshe dyái-ya-ʔya*

STA-LOC ascend-SS =2 quiet-ADV.ADJ still-ADV.ADJ sit-IRR-ASSR

“You shall go up and silently sit still.”

(B&CU, p. 125; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

c. COMPATIBLE WITH *-mbi* NEG

*tsá-ʔkan-si sú-si =ki íngi=ma=jan páña-mbi-ʔya*

ANA-SML-DS say-DS =2 1PL=ACC=CNTR hear-NEG-ASSR

“(We’ve) told you so and you haven’t listened to us.”

(B&CU, p. 130; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The assertive *-ʔya* ASSR is compatible only with assertions (99a) (Fischer and Hengeveld, 2023; Hengeveld and Fischer, in prep.). As such, it cannot co-occur with the polar question second-position clitic *=ti* YNQ (even if the two are not linearly adjacent) (99b), appear in WH-questions (formed by fronting indefinite expressions, such as *ma-jan* IDSL-CNTR “who”) (99c), or combine with any of the matrix-clausal directive suffixes (99d).

(99) ASSERTIVE *-ɣa* ASSR INCOMPATIBLE WITH OTHER ILLOCUTIONARY ACTS

## a. COMPATIBLE WITH ASSERTIONS

*táyu =tsû pá-ɣa*  
already =3 die-ASSR

“S/he’s dead already.”

(BC&C, p. 158; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## b. INCOMPATIBLE WITH =TI YNQ

\**táyu =ti pá-ɣa?*  
already =YNQ die-ASSR

intended: “Is s/he dead already?”

(2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## c. INCOMPATIBLE WITH WH-QUESTIONS

\**má-jan =tsû táyu pá-ɣa?*  
IDSL-CNTR =3 already die-ASSR

intended: “Who’s dead already?”

(2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

## d. INCOMPATIBLE WITH DIRECTIVE SUFFIXES

\**táyu pá-ja-ɣa*  
already die-IMP-ASSR

intended: “Die already!”

(2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

The assertive *-ɣa* ASSR makes no restrictions regarding the source of the asserted information. As such, *-ɣa* ASSR is compatible with speech reports marked with *=te* RPRT (100).

(100) ASSERTIVE *-ɣa* ASSR COMPATIBLE WITH SPEECH REPORTS

*táyu =te pá-ɣa*  
already =RPRT die-ASSR

“S/he’s (allegedly) dead already.”

(2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## 4.4.2 Cosubordinating morphology

A’ingae has two switch-reference morphemes that encode whether or not the subjects of two connected clauses are the same (*-pa* ss and *-si* ds), and appear in three constructions: clause chaining, adverbial clauses, and “bridging” clause linkage. The same-subject *-pa* ss is used if the subject of the *pa*-marked clause and the subject of the following clause are the same (101a). The different-subject *-si* ds is used if the subject of the *si*-marked clause and the subject of the following clause are different (101b). (For more on the functions of switch-reference morphemes, see Section 3.4 and AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva, 2023.)

## (101) SWITCH-REFERENCE COSUBORDINATORS

a. SAME-SUBJECT *-pa* SS

*ápi=ma píɣpi-pa ísû*  
clay=ACC mold-ss take

“(S/he) made a clay pot and picked it up.” (AI, p. 13; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

b. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT *-si* DS

*arápa pá-si =tsû ísû*  
chicken die-ds =3 take

“The chicken died and s/he picked it up.” (AI, p. 13; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

The same-subject *-pa* ss (102) and different-subject *-si* ds (103) are both compatible with templatically preceding morphology, including voice (102-103a), aspectual (102-103b), and associated motion (102-103c) suffixes.

(102) SAME-SUBJECT *pa*-CLAUSES COMPATIBLE WITH TEMPLATICALLY PREVIOUS MORPHEMES

- |                                                             |                                                             |                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>seje-yé-pa</i><br>cure-PASS-SS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) | b. <i>búthu-jí-pa</i><br>run-INGR-SS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) | c. <i>séma-ʔngi-pa</i><br>work-VEN-SS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|

(103) DIFFERENT-SUBJECT *si*-CLAUSES COMPATIBLE WITH TEMPLATICALLY PREVIOUS MORPHEMES

- |                                                             |                                                              |                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. <i>tshai-yé-si</i><br>hit-PASS-DS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) | b. <i>búthu-ʔje-si</i><br>run-IPFV-DS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) | c. <i>tshái-ʔngi-si</i><br>hit-VEN-DS<br>(2025-09-16(1)_mll) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|

Situation-level inflection, such as *-ʔfa* PLS and *-ya* IRR, tends to be expressed on the final matrix verb (not the *pa/si*-marked clause), although there are additional factors at play. For example, if the subject (and hence subject number) is the same across two cosubordinate clauses, plurality is marked only on the last verb; a redundant *-ʔfa* PLS on a *pa*-marked clause is judged as incorrect (104a). However, if the subjects are different, the subject number may differ between clauses. As such, *si*-clauses can be marked with *-ʔfa* PLS (104b).

(104) SWITCH REFERENCE AND *-ʔfa* PLS

- |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. REDUNDANT <i>-ʔfa</i> PLS ILLICIT<br><i>kháʔya(*-ʔfa)-pa =tsû án-ʔfa</i><br>swim-PLS-SS =3 eat-PLS<br>“They swam and ate.”<br>(2025-09-05(1)_mll) | b. NON-REDUNDANT <i>-ʔfa</i> PLS LICIT<br><i>kháʔya-ʔfa-si tsû án-ʔfa</i><br>swim-PLS-DS =3 eat-PLS<br>“They swam and (some other people) ate (them).” (2025-09-05(1)_mll) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

In clause chaining constructions, the irrealis *-ya* IRR appears only on the last matrix verb (105a). The futurity conveyed by *-ya* IRR may scope over just the last verb (105a.i) or the entire clause (105a.ii). When the irrealis *-ya* IRR appears within a cosubordinated clause, the clause receives an adverbial reading (105b).

(105) SWITCH REFERENCE AND *-ya* IRR

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| a. VARIABLE SCOPE OF <i>-ya</i> IRR<br>i. <i>semá-mba =tsû [án]-ña</i><br>ii. [ <i>semá-mba =tsû án</i> ]-ña<br>work-SS =3 eat-IRR<br>i. “S/he worked and will eat.”<br>ii. “S/he will work and eat.”<br>(2025-09-05(1)_mll) | b. <i>-ya</i> IRR LICIT IN AN ADVERBIAL <i>pa</i> -CLAUSE<br><i>semá-ña-mba =tsû án</i><br>work-IRR-SS =3 eat<br>“Because s/he’ll work, s/he ate.”<br>(2025-09-05(1)_mll) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

The negation *-mbi* NEG only takes scope over the clause to which it overtly attaches (106a). In order to negate a cosubordinate clause, *-mbi* NEG needs to appear within it (106b).

## (106) SWITCH REFERENCE AND -MBI NEG

## a. LOW SCOPE OF -MBI NEG

i. *semá-mba =tsû [án]-mbi*ii. \**[semá-mba =tsû án]-mbi*

work-ss =3 eat-NEG

i. "S/he worked and did not eat."

ii. not: "\*S/he did not work or eat."

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

## b. -MBI NEG NEGATING A PA-CLAUSE

*semá-mbi-pa =tsû án-mbi*

work-NEG-ss =3 eat-NEG

"S/he did not work and did not eat."

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

## 4.4.3 Subordinating morphology

In this section, I describe the A'ingae subordinating morphemes. The A'ingae verbal subordinators include the apprehensional *-saʔne* APPR, the tentative *-khen* TENT, the same-subject conditional antecedent (phonologically unrealized in most contexts), the different-subject conditional antecedent *-ʔni* IF.DS, and the frustrative *-ʔma* FRST.

**THE APPREHENSIONAL** The apprehensional *-saʔne* APPR marks undesirable potential future situations (107). Three main verbal functions of the morpheme may be distinguished: avertive precautioning (107a), in-case precautioning (107b), and *fear-complementizer* (107c). These three functions of *-saʔne* APPR are similar to the range of uses of the archaic English *lest* (Dąbkowski and AnderBois, 2024).

## (107) FUNCTIONS OF -SAʔNE APPR

## a. AVERTIVE PRECAUTIONING

*sinthí-mbe-ʔyi tsû kán-ña-ʔchu kháse anjámpa tshán-saʔne*

blow-ADV.NEG-T-EXCL =3 AUX-IRR-EN again blood bleed-APPR

"You should not blow your nose, so that you don't make it bleed again."

(P&amp;C, pp. 68–69; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## b. IN-CASE PRECAUTIONING

*ñá ké sepákhû-ʔfa=ma kán já-ye thési ké=nga jí-saʔne*

1SG 2SG back-LAT=ACC watch go-INF jaguar 2SG=DAT come-APPR

"I will watch your back in case a jaguar comes at you."

(C4, p. 27; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## c. FEAR-COMPLEMENTIZER

*dyúju-pa =ngi aʔtú-tshe súmbu, ké ñá=ma fíʔthi-pa tísû*

be afraid-ss =1 hide-ADV.ADJ leave 2SG 1SG=ACC kill-ss REFL

*unkeʔngé=ndekhû=ma ítsa-saʔne*

daughter=PL.ANIM=ACC snatch-APPR

"I sneaked out because I was afraid that you would kill me, and take your daughters from me by force."

(Genesis 31:31; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

First, the apprehensional *-saʔne* APPR may introduce avertive precautioning clausal adjuncts. In this use, the matrix clause presents a situation aimed at averting an undesirable state of affairs. The *saʔne*-marked clause presents the undesirable state of affairs. For example, in (107a), the addressee should not blow their nose to avoid causing another nosebleed.

The avertive precautioning use of *-saʔne* APPR expresses the goal of *not* achieving a particular state of affairs. As such, it is synonymous with the negative rationale clauses expressed via the periphrastic *mbe kañe*-construction discussed in Paragraph 4.3 (108, cf. 107a).

- (108) NEGATIVE RATIONALE *MBE KAÑE*-CLAUSES SYNONYMOUS WITH AVERTIVE *SAʔNE*-CLAUSES  
*sinthí-mbe-ʔ-yi*                      *=tsû kán-ña-ʔchu kháse anjám̐pa tshán-mbe kan-ñe*  
 blow-ADV.NEG-T-EXCL =3 AUX-IRR-EN again blood bleed-ADV.NEG AUX-INF  
 “You should not blow your nose, so that you don’t make it bleed again.”  
 (2024-03-04(1)\_sia)

Second, *-saʔne* APPR may introduce in-case precautioning clausal adjuncts. In this case, the *saʔne*-marked clause presents a situation that may have undesirable consequences, but the action of the matrix clause is not aimed (or capable of being aimed) at averting the *saʔne*-marked situation. Rather, it is intended only to avert its unstated consequences. For example, in (107b), the speaker watching the addressee’s back won’t affect the chances of running into a jaguar—it might, however, alter the outcome of such an encounter.

Third, *-saʔne* APPR may introduce clausal complements of verbs with emotionally negative connotations such as *fear* or *not want*. E. g., in (107c), the emotional state of mind of the subject is not averting the undesirable situation of being killed by the addressee. Rather, *-saʔne* APPR introduces the content of fear as a clausal complement of the verb *dyuju* ‘be afraid.’

The apprehensional *-saʔne* APPR is compatible with voice (109a), aspect (109b) associated motion (109c) suffixes. The suffix *-saʔne* APPR is also compatible with the plural subject *-ʔfa* PLS (110a) and the negative *-mbi* NEG (110b). However, it is not compatible with the irrealis *-ya* IRR (111a) or the infinitive *-ye* INF (111b).<sup>13</sup>

- (109) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-SAʔNE* APPR AND PRECEDING SUFFIXES  
 a. *íʔna-en-saʔne*                      b. *sumbu-khá-saʔne*                      c. *shukháen-ʔngi-saʔne*  
     cry-CAUS-APPR                      leave-VDM-APPR                      cook-VEN-APPR  
     (2025-09-16(1)\_mll)                      (2025-09-16(1)\_mll)                      (2025-09-16(1)\_mll)
- (110) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-SAʔNE* APPR AND *-ʔFA* PLS, *-MBI* NEG  
 a. *fiʔthi-ʔfa-saʔne*                      b. *jí-mbi-saʔne*  
     kill-PLS-APPR                      come-NEG-APPR  
     (2024-02-14(1)\_sia)                      (2020-11-19\_sia)
- (111) INCOMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-SAʔNE* APPR AND *-YA* IRR, *-YE* INF  
 a. *\*akheʔpa-ya-saʔne*                      b. *\*akheʔpa-ye-saʔne*  
     forger-IRR-APPR                      forget-INF-APPR  
     (2024-03-04(1)\_sia)                      (2024-03-04(1)\_sia)

THE TENTATIVE The tentative *-khen* TENT introduces subordinate verbs in auxiliary constructions that express an attempt or effort on the part of the subject to accomplish something (112). A *khen*-marked clause may be introduced as a complement to verbs such as *tsun* ‘do’ (112a), *iyikhu* ‘fight’ (112b), or *vana* ‘suffer’ (112c). They are most often translated with the Spanish *tratar de (hacer)* ‘try to (do sth),’ *pelear para (hacer)* ‘wrestle to (do sth),’ and *sufir para (hacer)* ‘struggle to (do sth).’

(112) FUNCTIONS OF *-KHEN* TENT

a. COMPLEMENT OF *TSUN* ‘DO’

*Tetéte =tsû ingi=ma fi?thí-khen tsún-si =ngi dyú-pa jí-pa vá=ni kán?jen-?fa*  
 Waorani =3 1PL=ACC kill-TENT do-DS =1 fear-SS come-SS DEM=LOC be.ANIM-PLS  
 “The Tetetes tried to kill us, so we came to stay here out of fear.”

(AC2, pp. 9, 50; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

b. COMPLEMENT OF *IYIKHU* ‘FIGHT’

*in?ján-khen-jan iyíkhú-?je =ngi*  
 believe-TENT-CNTR fight-IPFV =1  
 “I am wrestling to believe.”

(2024-06-18(1)\_mll)

c. COMPLEMENT OF *VANA* ‘SUFFER’

*athe-yé-khen =ngi vána-?jen*  
 see-PASS-TENT =1 suffer-IPFV  
 “I am struggling to be seen.”

(2024-06-11(2)\_mll)

The tentative *-khen* TENT is compatible with voice (113) and associated motion (115) suffixes, but not with aspectual (114) or situation-level (116) suffixes.

(113) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-KHEN* TENT AND VOICE SUFFIXES

a. *i?ná-en-khen*

cry-CAUS-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

b. *fetha-khú-khen*

open-RCPR-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

c. *athe-yé-khen*

see-PASS-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

(114) INCOMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-KHEN* TENT AND ASPECTUAL SUFFIXES

a. *\*fetha-?je-khen*

open-IPFV-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

b. *\*fetha-kha-khen*

open-VDM-TENT

(2022-07-20(1)\_jxm)

c. *\*fetha-?ñakha-khen*

open-ITER-TENT

(2025-09-12(1)\_mll)

(115) COMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-KHEN* TENT AND ASSOCIATED MOTION SUFFIXES

a. *fetha-?ngí-khen*

open-VEN-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

b. *fetha-?ngá-khen*

open-AND-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

(116) INCOMPATIBILITY BETWEEN *-KHEN* TENT AND SITUATION-LEVEL SUFFIXES

a. *\*fetha-?fa-khen*

open-PLS-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

b. *\*fetha-ya-khen*

open-IRR-TENT

(2022-07-20(1)\_jxm)

c. *\*fetha-mbi-khen*

open-NEG-TENT

(2025-09-05(1)\_mll)

- 13 Additionally, the apprehensional morpheme can be used on noun phrases, where it functions as timitive case clitic *=sa?ne* APPR, marking a feared entity as a motive for the subject’s actions. For further discussion of the A’ingae apprehensional *-sa?ne* APPR, including descriptions of its uses and a formal analysis thereof, see AnderBois and Dąbkowski (2020) and Dąbkowski and AnderBois (2024, 2026). For an overview of apprehensional functions across languages and a typological framework for describing and comparing apprehensional synchrony and diachrony, see AnderBois and Dąbkowski (2025).

THE SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL A'ingae distinguishes between same- and different-subject conditionals. As such, A'ingae conditionals participate in the same switch-reference system as that is encoded by *-pa* SS and *-si* DS in non-conditional cosubordinating constructions (discussed in §4.4.2).

Same-subject conditional antecedents do not, in most circumstances, receive any overt dedicated marking. Rather, they are expressed solely by marking the antecedent with information structural morphology (117). (On most other constituents, discourse marking is optional. However, a same-subject antecedent is always introduced by at least one IS morpheme.) This way of marking antecedents is restricted to same-subject conditionals (117c); different-subject antecedents must be marked with *-ʔni* IF.DS (to be discussed in §4.4.3).<sup>14</sup>

In same-subject conditional constructions, a discourse marker is attached directly to an (inflected) verb. As such, a glottal stop *-ʔ* T is realized between the verb and the IS marker (117) (see §4.3).

(117) SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL MARKED ONLY WITH *-ʔ* T + IS

a. *-ʔ* T + *-TA* NEW

*charápa dūsúchu-ʔje-si, áthe-ʔ-ta kánʔjen-mba jí-ye*  
 turtle lay egg-IPFV-DS see-T-NEW stay-SS come-INF

“If we see that the turtles are laying eggs, we will stay for a while and then return.” (AV, p. 13; 2024-02-14(1)\_sia)

b. *-ʔ* T + *-JA* CNTR

*ké pá-mbi-ʔ-ja páña kánse-ʔfa-ja*  
 2SG die-NEG-T-CNTR hear live-PLS-IMP

“If you don’t die, live to hear (what is going to happen).”

(Hengeveld and Fischer, in prep., 20040218-EC-Interview-123;  
 2024-02-15(1)\_sia)

c. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL UNGRAMMATICAL WITHOUT *-ʔni* IF.DS

\**ñá úfa-ʔje-ʔ-ta kankankáun jí*  
 1SG blow-IPFV-T-NEW red-throated caracara come

intended: “When I was hunting with a blowgun, a red-throated caracara flew by.” (cf. 121a) (2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

A different structure is seen when the additive focus marker *-ʔkhe* ADD appears on a same-subject conditional antecedent. In those cases, an additional morpheme *-ʔa* IF.SS is obligatorily present between the subordinated verb and *-ʔkhe* ADD (118).

14 A'ingae conditional constructions may have afactual and factual interpretations. Afactual conditionals do not presuppose that the antecedent will obtain and can often be translated with “if.” Factual conditionals presuppose that the antecedent will obtain and can be translated e. g. with “when,” “after,” or “as soon as.” There is no morphological distinction between afactual and factual conditionals. Counterfactual conditionals are marked with the similative morpheme *-ʔkan* SML. For more on the A'ingae counterfactuals, see Dąbkowski (2021b).

- (118) SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL MARKED WITH  $-ʔA$  IF.SS WHEN FOLLOWED BY  $-ʔKHE$  ADD  
*kuénza áʔi=ve dá-ʔa-ʔkhe ñú-ʔa áʔi=ya =tsû*  
 old person=ACC2 become-IF.SS-ADD good-ADN person=IRR =3

“Also when s/he grows old, s/he will be a good person.”

(Borman, 1981, pp. 16–17; 2025-01-20(1)\_mll)

The morpheme  $-ʔa$  IF.SS does not (often) appear in circumstances other than before  $-ʔkhe$  ADD in same-subject conditional clauses. In addition, it is disallowed before the other IS markers (119). As such, I propose that  $-ʔa$  IF.SS is an overt realization of the same-subject conditional morpheme (contextually conditioned by adjacency to  $-ʔkhe$  ADD) and gloss it accordingly.

- (119) OVERT  $-ʔA$  IF.SS ALLOWED AND REQUIRED ONLY IMMEDIATELY BEFORE  $-ʔKHE$  ADD
- |                         |                         |                         |                      |
|-------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|
| a. <i>*jí-ʔa(-ʔ)-ta</i> | b. <i>*jí-ʔa(-ʔ)-ja</i> | c. <i>*jí-ʔa(-ʔ)-yi</i> | d. <i>*jí-ʔkhe</i>   |
| come-IF.SS-T-NEW        | come-IF.SS-T-CNTR       | come-IF.SS-T-EXCL       | come-ADD             |
| intended:               | intended:               | intended:               | intended:            |
| “if (sb) comes”         | “if (sb) comes”         | “only if (sb) comes”    | “also if (sb) comes” |
- (2025-01-20(1)\_mll)

Same-subject conditionals are compatible with all templatically preceding morphology, including voice (120a), verbal inflectional (120b), and situation-level (120c) suffixes.

- (120) SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONALS COMPATIBLE WITH ALL PREVIOUS MORPHEMES
- |                        |                          |                       |
|------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|
| a. <i>afa-khú-ʔ-ja</i> | b. <i>fúndu-ʔje-ʔ-ta</i> | c. <i>pá-mbi-ʔ-ja</i> |
| speak-RCPR-T-CNTR      | scream-IPFV-T-NEW        | die-NEG-T-CNTR        |
| (2024-06-11(2)_mll)    | (2025-08-28(1)_mll)      | (2024-02-15(1)_sia)   |

**THE DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL** Different-subject conditional antecedents are introduced by the always overt  $-ʔni$  IF.DS (121).<sup>15</sup> Different-subject antecedents are frequently accompanied by a topic marker (121b), but that is not obligatory (121a). If the subject of the antecedent is the same as that of the consequent,  $-ʔni$  IF.DS is ungrammatical (121c).

<sup>15</sup> In some previous descriptions and analyses, including AnderBois, Altshuler, and Silva (2023), Fischer and Hengeveld (2023), and Hengeveld and Fischer (2018), the different-subject conditional antecedent  $-ʔni$  IF.DS was conflated with the locative case marker  $=ni$  LOC and glossed as such. In this paper,  $-ʔni$  IF.DS is analyzed as distinct from  $=ni$  LOC for three reasons.

First,  $-ʔni$  IF.DS is preglottalized and  $=ni$  LOC is not. Glottalization is a contrastive feature of A'ingae functional morphemes, and may distinguish between semantically unrelated markers, e. g. the infinitive suffix  $-ye$  INF vs. the deceased honorific  $=ʔye$  DCS.

Second,  $-ʔni$  IF.DS and  $=ni$  LOC have different meanings. The former introduces different-subject conditional antecedents, and the latter is a locative case maker.

Third,  $-ʔni$  IF.DS and  $=ni$  LOC attach to constituents of different types. The different-subject antecedent  $-ʔni$  IF.DS attaches to (often verbal) predicates, while  $=ni$  LOC attaches to (usually nominal) adjuncts. Insofar as both  $-ʔni$  IF.DS and  $=ni$  LOC can attach to the same word, e. g. *atesû* ‘learn’ (i), they have different meanings. Additionally, they occur with different stress patterns, cf. the antepenultimate stress of *atesû-ʔni-nda* ‘learn-IF.DS-NEW’ (ia) with the preantepenultimate stress of *atesû-ni-nda* ‘learn-LOC-NEW’ (ib).

## (121) DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL ANTECEDENT -ʔNI IF.DS

## a. BARE -ʔNI IF.DS

ñá ũfa-ʔje-ʔni kankankáun jí-si ũfa-ʔma déʔjian-mbi  
 1SG blow-IPFV-IF.DS red-throated caracara come-DS blow-FRST hit-NEG

“When I was hunting with a blowgun, a red-throated caracara flew by, and I shot (blew) at it, but I missed.” (AV, p. 40; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## b. -ʔNI IF.DS + -TA NEW

síme yáya tsámpi=ne jí-si jungué-sû áñaʔchu=ma í-ʔni-jan  
 evening dad forest-ELAT come-DS IDSB-ATTR meat=ACC bring-IF.DS-CNTR  
 sáʔsa-pa shúʔkhaen-mba púiyiʔkhu án-ʔfa-ya  
 skin-SS cook-SS everyone eat-PLS-IRR

“In the evening, when dad returns from hunting, (the mother and the girls) will prepare whatever meat he has brought. They’ll cook it and everyone will eat it.” (AV, p. 16; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

## c. SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL UNGRAMMATICAL WITH -ʔNI IF.DS

\*ké pá-mbi-ʔni páña kánse-ja  
 2SG die-NEG-IF.DS hear live-IMP

intended: “If you don’t die, live to hear.” (cf. 117b) (2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

The different-subject conditional -ʔni IF.DS is compatible with all preceding morphology, including voice (122a), verbal inflectional (122b), and situation-level (122c) suffixes.

## (122) DIFFERENT-SUBJECT ʔNI-CONDITIONALS COMPATIBLE WITH ALL PREVIOUS MORPHEMES

## a. kû-ñá-ʔni-nda

red-CAUS-IF.DS-NEW

(2025-09-16(1)\_mll)

## b. sú-ʔje-ʔni

speak-IPFV-IF.DS

(2025-01-20(1)\_mll)

## c. áthe-ʔfa-ʔni-ñi

see-PLS-IF.DS-EXCL

(2024-06-18(1)\_mll)

Topics and conditional constructions in many languages receive similar (or identical) morphological expression (Haiman, 1978). In A’ingae, this is seen in that same-subject conditionals are expressed only with information structural morphology, and different-subject conditionals are often accompanied by topic markers. Observe, however, that different-subject conditionals have their own dedicated morpheme (-ʔni IF.DS) and do not obligatorily require topic marking (121a). As such, the expression of A’ingae conditionality cannot be simply reduced to topichood. For a complete analysis of the morphosyntax of A’ingae conditionals, see Dąbkowski (2025b,e).

## (i) MINIMAL (ʔ)NI-PAIR

## a. DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL -ʔNI IF.DS

dúʔshû atesû-ʔni-nda =ngi já-ya  
 child learn-IF.DS-NEW =1 go-IRR

“If (the) child learns, I will go.”  
 (2025-09-16(1)\_mll)

## b. LOCATIVE CASE =NI LOC

dúʔshû atésû-ni-nda =ngi já-ya  
 child learn-LOC-NEW =1 go-IRR

“I will go to where (the) child learned.”  
 (2025-09-16(1)\_mll)

**THE FRUSTRATIVE** Finally, A'ingae has a frustrative marker *-ʔma* FRST, which contrasts two clauses that are in some way in opposition to one another (123). A'ingae thus patterns with other Amazonian languages, which often feature some morphological mean to express non-realization of an expected outcome (Overall, 2017). Morvillo and AnderBois (2022) analyze the A'ingae *-ʔma* FRST as essentially synonymous with the English *but*. Their proposal captures the vast majority of the morpheme's uses.

(123) CONTRASTIVE FUNCTION OF *-ʔMA* FRST

*tíse máma khén áfa-si Ferípe=ja atesú-mbi-pa ásiʔthaen-ʔma ushá-mbi-pa ána*  
 3SG mom thus speak-DS Philip=CNTR know-NEG-SS think-FRST be able-SS sleep

“His mom asked him (the riddle) and Philip did not know (the answer). He thought but he could not (guess) and he fell asleep.”

(AIV, p. 28; 2024-02-15(1)\_sia)

Additionally, the frustrative *-ʔma* FRST may also be used to express a narrowly averted event when followed immediately by *khúsha* ‘recover’ (124c). Crucially, this interpretation is available only when the two verbs form one phonological phrase. If there is a prosodic break after the *ʔma*-marked verb, only the contrastive interpretation is available (124b).

(124) PROSODY-DEPENDENT INTERPRETATIONS OF *-ʔMA* FRST

a. NARROWLY AVOIDED EVENT

*tíse =tsû amphí-ʔma khúsha*  
 3SG =3 fall-FRST recover

“S/he almost fell.”

(2023-08-21(5)\_sia)

b. CONTRASTIVE

*tíse =tsû amphí-ʔma, | khúsha*  
 3SG =3 fall-FRST recover

“S/he fell, but s/he recovered.”

(2023-08-21(5)\_sia)

The frustrative *-ʔma* FRST is compatible with all templatically preceding morphology, including voice (122a), verbal inflectional (125b), and situation-level (125c) suffixes.

(125) DIFFERENT-SUBJECT CONDITIONALS COMPATIBLE WITH ALL PREVIOUS MORPHEMES

a. *púʔta-en-ʔma*

pierce-CAUS-FRST

(2024-04-02(1)\_sia)

b. *áthe-ji-ʔma*

see-INGR-FRST

(2025-09-16(1)\_mll)

c. *jí-ya-ʔma*

come-IRR-FRST

(2025-09-16(1)\_mll)

#### 4.5 Information structural morphology

A'ingae has four morphemes dedicated to encoding discourse-related information: two encoding focus, and two—topichood. A'ingae discourse morphemes may attach to subordinate and cosubordinate verbs, but not to matrix clausal verbs. (In addition, the IS markers may also appear on non-verbal arguments and adjuncts of various sorts.) Below, I briefly state what their main uses are, and show what sorts of clauses they appear on. For a fuller description of the A'ingae IS markers, see Dąbkowski (in prep.).

**THE EXCLUSIVE FOCUS** The exclusive focus *-yi* EXCL indicates that a proposition holds of the marked entity to the exclusion of alternatives; it can often be translated as “only” (126).

(126) EXCLUSIVE FOCUS *-YI* EXCL

*tsá-ʔka-en pá-ʔfa-si khuánifae tsandié=ndekhû=yi khûshá-ʔfa*  
ANA-SML-ADV die-PLS-DS three man=PL.ANIM-EXCL survive-PLS

“When they thus died, only three men were spared.”

(B&CU, p. 37; 2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

**THE ADDITIVE FOCUS** The additive focus *-ʔkhe* ADD indicates that the proposition holds of the marked entity in addition to some alternatives; it can often be translated as “too,” “as well,” or “also” (127).

(127) ADDITIVE FOCUS *-ʔKHE* ADD

*tsá-ʔma áthe-pa fáesû=ma=ʔkhe áthe*  
ANA-ACC see-SS other=ACC=ADD see

“When (he) looked, (he) also saw another one.”

(B&CU, p. 38; 2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

**THE NEW TOPIC** The new topic marker *-ta* NEW indicates that the referent was not previously present in the discourse. For example, the marker often appears on individuals that are introduced for the first time (128).

(128) REFERENT INTRODUCED WITH *-TA* NEW

[seeing a city in the distance for the first time:]

*jú-va tútu-a=ta =ti patú-ndûʔndû*  
DIST-DEM white-ADN=NEW =YNQ rock-beach

“Is that white over there a rocky beach?”

(AV, p. 24; 2025-08-26(1)\_mll)

**THE CONTRASTIVE TOPIC** The contrastive topic marker *-ja* CNTR is used in the presence of alternative topics in the discourse, especially when information about different individuals is overtly or covertly juxtaposed. For example, it may be used on a subject which contrasts with other discourse participants in whether they took part in some activity (129).

(129) SUBJECT PROPERTY CONTRASTED WITH *-JA* CNTR

[dialogue between A and B:

A: Who all went?

B: Dad, my uncle, and my older brother.]

A: *mí-nga-ʔu-si =ki ké=ja já-mbi*  
IDDG-DAT-ADJ-DS =2 2SG=CNTR GO-NEG

“Why didn’t you go?”

(AV, p. 9; 2025-08-26(1)\_mll)

The discourse markers can appear on various non-matrix clauses (130), including e. g. rationale clauses (130a), conditionals (130b,e), switch-reference clauses (130c), and precautioning *saʔne*-clauses (130d).

(130) DISCOURSE MARKERS ON NON-MATRIX VERBAL CONSTITUENTS

a. -YI EXCL AND -TA NEW ON A RATIONALE YE-CLAUSE

*júsû afa-khú-ye-ʔ-yi-ta* =ngi áʔingae=ma atésû-ʔje  
only speak-RCPR-INF-T-EXCL-NEW =1 A'ingae=ACC learn-IPFV

"I am studying A'ingae only so that I can argue (with people)."

(2025-01-20(1)\_mll)

b. -ʔKHE ADD ON A SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL ʔA-CLAUSE

*khúpa-ʔnga-pa jí-ʔa-ʔkhe* =tsû utishí-ya-ʔchu  
defecate-AND-SS come-IF.SS-ADD =3 wash hands-IRR-EN

"After using the restroom, one must also wash hands."

(AV, p. 27; 2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

c. -TA NEW ON A SWITCH REFERENCE SI-CLAUSE

*píyi kán-si-ta =ti tsífu=ja íñe?*  
turn look-DS-NEW =YNQ neck=CNTR hurt

"Does your neck hurt when you turn your head?"

(BC&C, p. 55; 2024-02-20(1)\_sia)

d. -JA CNTR ON A SAME-SUBJECT CONDITIONAL CLAUSE AND PRECAUTIONING SAʔNE-CLAUSE

*tayúpi=ja jungáe-sû=ma séma-ʔjen-ʔ-jan tsé-ʔthi=nga =tsû má-ʔka-en*  
long ago=CNTR IDSB-ATTR=ACC work-IPFV-T-CNTR STA-PLC=DAT =3 IDSL-SML-ADV  
*jungáe-sû=ma kháʔna-saʔne-jan íyûʔû-pa kúndase-ʔfa*  
IDSB-ATTR=ACC steal-APPR-CNTR scold-SS tell-PLS

"In the old days, when (young people) were working on something (for someone else), (their fathers) would caution them not to steal anything from there."

(Criollo and Blanco Pisabarro, 1992, pp. 43, 90; 2024-03-04(1)\_sia)

A'ingae topic markers interact with second-position clitics. While the P2 clitics are prototypically optional in matrix clauses (§3.3.1), they are strongly preferred when a constituent marked with the new topic *-ta* NEW is present (131).

(131) P2 CLITIC PREFERRED AFTER NEW TOPIC -TA NEW

a. *áin=nda* ?? (=tsû) *tsái-ye atésû* b. *án-ʔ-nda* ?? (=ngi) *khípuéʔsû-ya-mbi*  
dog=NEW =3 bite-INF know eat-T-NEW =1 hungry-IRR-NEG

"The dog bites."

"If I eat, I won't be hungry."

(2024-05-27(2)\_sia)

(2024-05-27(2)\_sia)

Moreover, P2 clitics are ungrammatical immediately after constituents marked with the contrastive topic *-ja* CNTR (Fischer and Hengeveld, 2023; Hengeveld and Fischer, in prep.) (132).

## (132) P2 CLITIC DISALLOWED AFTER CONTRASTIVE TOPIC -JA CNTR

## a. CONTRASTIVE TOPIC WITHOUT PREGLOTTALIZATION -JA

\*áʔtse=ja (\*=tsû) tsáʔu=nga (=tsû) káʔni  
 hummingbird=CNTR =3 house=DAT =3 enter

“A hummingbird entered the house.”

(2024-04-03(1)\_sia)

## b. CONTRASTIVE TOPIC WITH PREGLOTTALIZATION -ʔJA

afa-khú-ʔ-ja (\*=ngi) sumbú-ya (=ngi)  
 speak-RCPR-T-CNTR =1 leave-IRR =1

“If I argue, I will leave.”

(2024-06-11(2)\_mll)

Finally, the A'ingae discourse markers are compatible with all templatically preceding morphemes, but there are some co-occurrence restrictions within the set of discourse markers. The exclusive focus -yi EXCL may be followed by the additive focus -ʔkhe ADD (133a), or by either topic marker (133b-c). The additive focus -ʔkhe ADD may be followed by the new topic -ta NEW (133d). The two topic markers -ta NEW and -ja CNTR are mutually incompatible (133e-f).

## (133) COMPATIBILITY AMONG DISCOURSE MARKERS

## a. ávû=ve=yi=ʔkhe

fish=ACC2=EXCL=ADD

(2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

## b. kánse-ʔfa-ʔ-yi-ta

live-PLS-T-EXCL-NEW

(2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

## c. áʔi=yi=ja

person=EXCL=CNTR

(2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

## d. ké=ʔkhe=ta

2SG=ADD=NEW

(2024-06-07(1)\_mll)

## e. \*ávû=ta=ja

fish=NEW=CNTR

(2026-03-09(1)\_jxm)

## f. \*ávû=ja=ta

fish=CNTR=NEW

(2026-03-09(1)\_jxm)

## 5 DISCUSSION

In summary, this paper has provided a brief overview of A'ingae clausal and verbal morphosyntax. We have seen that although A'ingae has a fairly free word order, second-position clitics play an important role in the study of various syntactic phenomena. For example, P2 clitics (i) interact with information structure, as they are incompatible with *ja*-marked contrastive topics (§3.3.1), (ii) interact with illocutionary force, as they are incompatible with directive sentences (§3.3.1), (iii) interact with syntactic clause status, as they are incompatible with (co)subordinate clauses (§3.4–5), (iv) diagnose movement to the left periphery, such as WH-fronting and pied-piping (§3.7.3).

A'ingae verbal morphology is highly agglutinating, with many different templatically-organized suffixes, which can be subdivided into voice (§4.1), verbal inflectional (§4.2), situation-level (§4.3), clause-type (§4.4), and information structural (§4.5) morphology. One leitmotif of A'ingae morphosyntax is the recurring distinction between same-subject and different-subject clauses. In A'ingae, subject (non-)identity (i) is reflected in morphological marking on switch-reference clauses (-*pa* ss vs. -*si* ds) (§4.4.2), (ii) as well as

conditional clauses ( $-\emptyset$  IF.SS vs.  $-\text{?ni}$  IF.DS) (§4.4.3–4), and (iii) influences the licit P2 clitics positions in sentences with (co)subordinate clauses (§3.4–5).

Some aspects of the language's morphology and syntax reflect the typological properties of the Amazonian sprachbund. For example, both nominalization (Overall and Wojtylak, 2018) and clause chaining (Aikhenvald, 2012; Sarvasy and Aikhenvald, 2024; van Gijn, Haude, and Muysken, 2011) are common Amazonian strategies for combining clauses. Some kind of overt marking of frustrativity (like the A'ingae  $-\text{?ma}$  FIRST) is also an areal feature (Overall, 2017). The fronting of WH-words in content questions is likewise widespread in the Amazon, and reported—among others—for Kariti'ana (Tupian; Vivanco, 2018), Kakataibo (Panoan; Zariquiey, 2018, p. 374), Baniwa (Maipurean; Ramirez, 2021, pp. 331 ff.; Cronhamn, 2025), and Hixkaryana (Cariban; Derbyshire, 1979, pp. 6–7).<sup>16</sup>

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<sup>16</sup> However, WH-fronting is not universal in the region. For example, Ticuna (isolate) has been reported to allow WH-words both clause-initially and in-situ (Montes Rodríguez, 2004, p. 153). Pirahã (Mura) has also been analyzed as a WH-in-situ language (Nevins, Pesetsky, and Rodrigues, 2009, p. 32).

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